XBOX 360™

DESIGN STYLE GUIDE

November 2007

Contents

Overview 4

General principles 5
Designing for TV 6
Safe area 6
Aspect ratio 6
Title Safe 7

Core elements 8

Navigation 10
Main navigation - blades 12
Left Column navigation 14
Full Width Column navigation 15
Grid navigation 16

Text elements 17
Fonts 18
Dash Text 19
Guide Text 20
Flex Buttons 21
Meta-Flex Buttons 22
Buttons 23
Meta panels 24

Design elements 25
Colors 26
Icons 28
Image tiles 30
Loaders 31

Templates 36
Live Blade 37
Games Blade 38
Media Blade 39
System Blade 40
Double line 41
Straight list 42
Two Tab 43
Image selector 45
Descriptive text 46
Left list 47
Media Player 48
Individual song 49

Guide 50
Guide look and feel 51
Guide home 52
Community 54
Message 56
Voice Message 57
On-screen Keyboard 58
Gamer Picture Select 59
Notification 60

Sound 62

Content 64
General Principles 65
Poster and Box Art Images 66
TV Network\Provider Images 68
Wallpaper Background Guidelines 69

Guide Themes 71
Gamer Pictures 72
Banners 72
Fonts 85
Icons 86
Animation 89
Branded Destination Experience (BDE) 96

Appendix 92

DESIGN STYLE GUIDE

Overview

Overview

The primary purpose of the Xbox 360 user interface is to be intuitive, fluent and enjoyable. It must embody the Xbox brand and its values. It is where the user interacts with the brand, one-on-one.

The visual language of the user interface is borne out by the Nexus logo and the console's industrial design - understated simplicity and refined forms. This is evident throughout the interface, from the hard shiny exterior of the blades, to the powerful, living interior of the background. The metallic blades reflect the steel surface of the Nexus sphere and the hard exterior of the console itself. It is these that contain the living interior, like the inside of the Nexus sphere itself, or the power within the Xbox 360 console. This is the core - a gaseous energy trapped behind the blades.

The slightly curved form of the individual elements communicates a friendly appeal and helps to balance the powerful, strong nature of the console itself. A feeling of calm is created with the interface that makes executing tasks and interacting with the console a stress-free and satisfying experience - the user interface should not be a game in itself. It is the ideal juxtaposition for the frantic, busy and lively game, movie, picture slide show or video web chat that it facilitates.

The three-point arc of the blades is taken directly from the console design, creating a solid bond between the hardware and software. The blades form the navigation which is based on one simple, universal philosophy:

- Present (where you are)
- Past (where you have been)
- Future (where you can go)

The blades are engineered to create clearly defined sections to house the main content. Relevant navigational options are always available so the user can never be lost - always instinctive and intuitive.

Jump In

GENERAL PRINCIPLES

Designing for TV / Colors on TV / Safe area

Generic principles

Designing for TV

There are a few basic principles that should be considered when designing interfaces for interactive TV.

- Keep it simple. Viewers don't read TV screens. Keep text short and to a minimum.
- Keep it big. Small graphics and thin lines don't render well on TV and are best avoided.
- Design from a distance. Remember viewers are not seeing the screen up close, so content needs to be large and clear enough to be viewed from a comfortable distance.
- Easy navigation. It has to be simple and intuitive.

Colors on TV

- TV-safe Colors must be used to avoid visual disturbances.
- Avoid saturated Colors in areas of small detail. While Colored backgrounds are used, they need to be carefully considered so that the Colors remain TV legal.
- Keep the 'Y' values of text and background as far apart as possible.

Safe area

- Keep content within the safe viewing area.
- Fit content within the page and avoid scrolling.
- Horizontal single lines must be a minimum of three pixels high to avoid flicker.

Aspect ratio

Templates have been designed to fit both 16:9 and 4:3 aspect ratios. It does this by either stretching or cropping or both. Each template is 1120 x 720 pixels and title safe is 590 x 955 pixels. Title safe should therefore be accurately observed as it addresses both of these aspect ratios.

Screen

1120 x 770

Title safe

955 x 590

CORE ELEMENTS

Xbox 360 UI Core Elements

Core elements

Blades
Metal blades act as the main navigation.

Background animation
Subtle background animation adds depth and interest to the pages.

Background panel
All content sits on a "glass" background panel to help legibility.

Screen heading
Every screen has a heading, and this may sit above the panel, on the panel or in some cases on a tab.

Content area
Content sits on the background panel and is navigated through using a grid system.

Legend buttons
A, B, Y and X buttons appear on all pages below the glass panel. The visual appearance of the buttons is consistent throughout (except when non-active) but the text labels change.

A Blades
B Background animation
C Background panel
D Screen heading
E Content area
F Legend

NAVIGATION

Main navigation / Left Column navigation /
Full Width Navigation / Grid Naviagation

Navigation

The blades form the main navigation. These sweep left and right as sections are selected, revealing content.

The content they reveal appears as a two-column grid which can be scrolled through up and down on the left side. The right side shows content associated with the buttons on the left (Meta Content).

The legend buttons appear on every page; however, the functions of these buttons change.

A Main navigation
B Content navigation
C Meta Content
D Legend buttons

Main navigation - blades

The steel-like blades are the main navigation. On the main level there can be a minimum of three and a maximum of five blades.

The blades create a feeling of depth - a dimension that you move through. While they sweep left to right, or right to left, when selected, they actually appear to move towards or away from the viewer. The active blade always appears closest to the viewer.

Each blade has a jewel containing the section name, or label.

Blades appearance

The blades have a metallic look, created using shadows and highlights. They should appear to overlap slightly. To add depth to the page, the blades at the back should be in darker shadow than those at the front.

The blades pick up a Color glow of the active section which casts a subtle hue over them.

Jewel appearance

The section name within the jewel should be shaped to follow the curve, so it looks integral.

When selected, the jewel takes on a glass-like appearance in the same Color as the section. The selected jewel also has a inner animation that emphasis depth and helps tie into the background animation.

Marketplace
1 left, 4 right

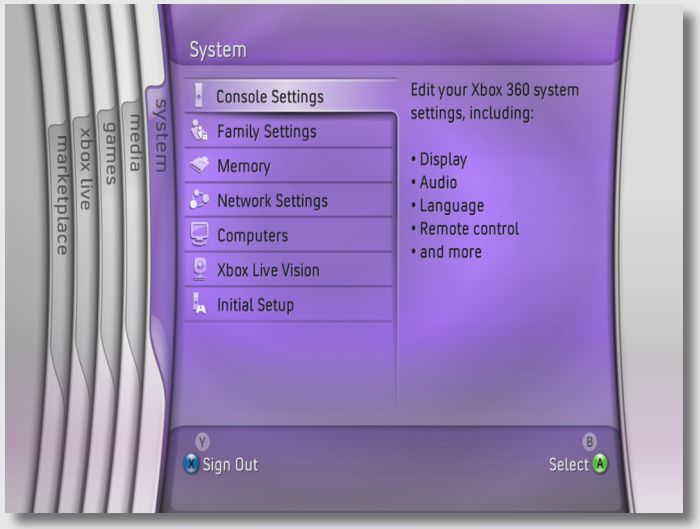
Xbox Live
2 left, 3 right

Games

3 left, 2 right

Media

4 left, 1 right



System

4 left, 0 right

Left Column Navigation

Content on Top level blades and the majority of 2nd and 3rd level screens can be formed into two column grid with buttons on the left side only. Content is made up of any combination of panels, banners, buttons and flex buttons.

The content can be navigated through up or down on the left side. There is no wrapping on the left column, if you navigate to the end of the column the focus does not jump back to the top.

Each item has a focus state that activates when it is rolled over. This uses a strong shadow and a bright highlight to give the impression of popping out of the screen.

An item that is non-selectable appears greyed-out. But it also has a focus state as you can still roll over it.

Flex buttons

- Maximum of four lines of text.
- Optional image tile (three size options) may reside to the left of the text.

Panels and banners

- Panels can contain text, a tile, buttons or icons.
- Banners could contain a feathered image and 2-3 short lines of text.(See banners section)

Buttons

- Buttons always sit on a content panel.
- Can contain an icon and/or numbers and text.

Gamer card focus

Achievements Focus

Live Arcade focus

Disc Tray focus

Full Width Column Navigation

Content on 2nd and 3rd level screens can be formed into a single column with buttons that span across the full content panel. Content is made up of any combination of panels, banners, and flex buttons.

The content can be navigated through up or down. There is no wrapping, if you navigate to the end of the column the focus does not jump back to the top.

Each item has a focus state that activates when it is rolled over. This uses a strong shadow and a bright highlight to give the impression of popping out of the screen.

An item that is non-selectable appears greyed-out. But it also has a focus state as you can still roll over it.

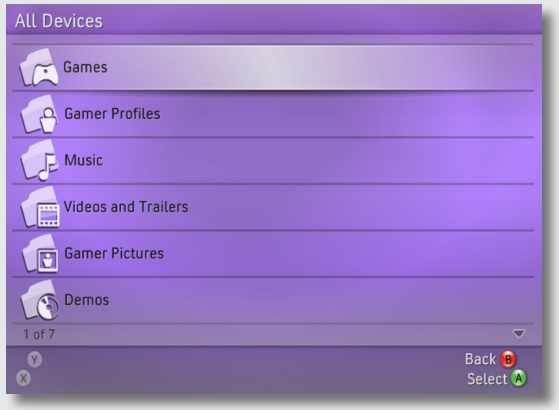
Flex buttons

- Maximum of four lines of text.
- Optional image tile (three size options) may reside to the left of the text.

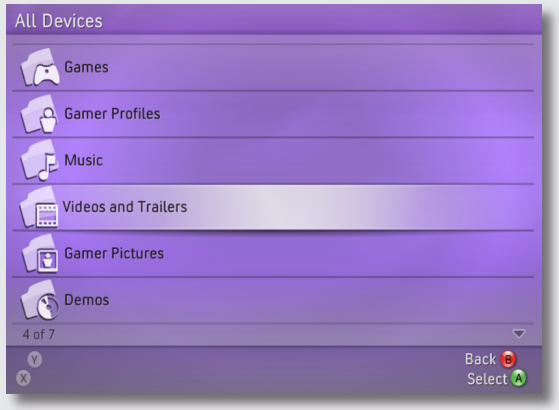
Panels and banners

- Panels can contain text, a tile, buttons or icons.
- Banners could contain a feathered image and 2-3 short lines of text. (See banners section)

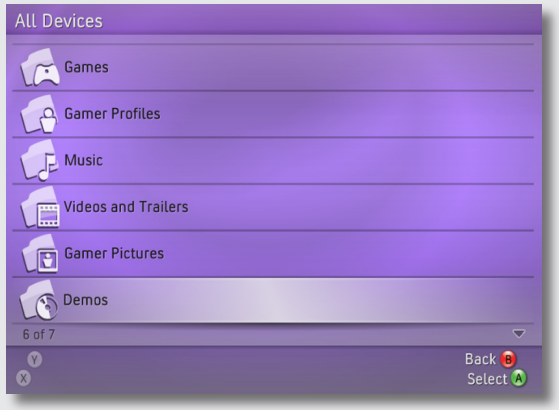
Games focus (top of scrolling list)



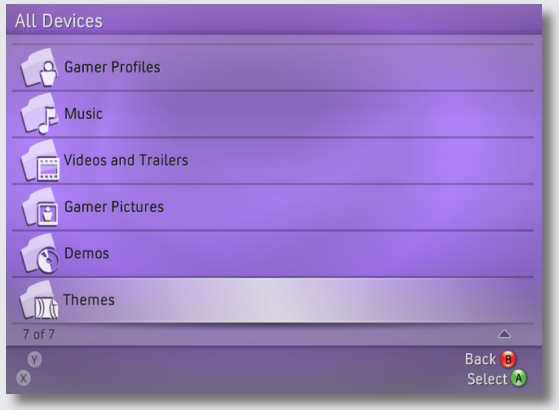
Videos/Trailers focus



Demos focus



Themes focus (bottom of scrolling list)



Grid navigation (2nd or 3rd level only)

Content in 2nd or 3rd level screens can be formed in a two-column grid. Content is made up of any combination of panels, banners, buttons and flex buttons.

The content can be navigated through up, down, left or right. There is no wrapping of columns or rows, if you navigate to the end of a column/ row the focus does not jump back to the top.

Each item has a focus state that activates when it is rolled over. This uses a strong shadow and a bright highlight to give the impression of popping out of the screen.

An item that is non-selectable appears greyed-out. But it also has a focus state as you can still roll over it.

Flex buttons

- Maximum of four lines of text.
- Optional image tile (three size options) may reside to the left of the text.

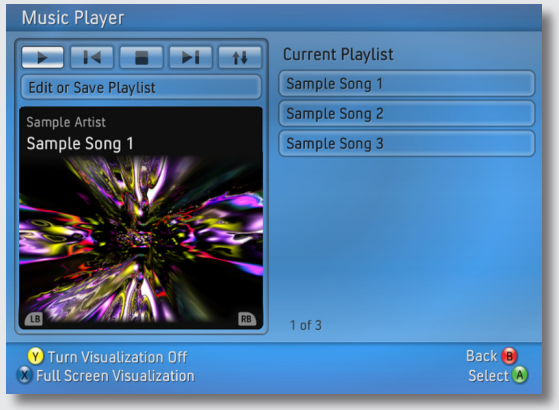
Panels and banners

- Panels can contain text, a tile, buttons or icons.
- Banners could contain a feathered image and 2-3 short lines of text. (See banners section)

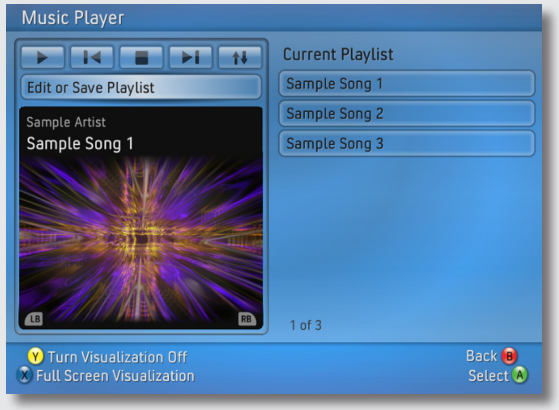
Buttons

- Buttons always sit on a content panel.
- Can contain an icon and/or numbers and text.

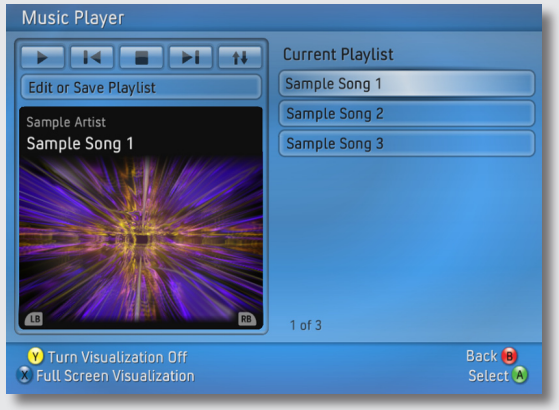
Play focus



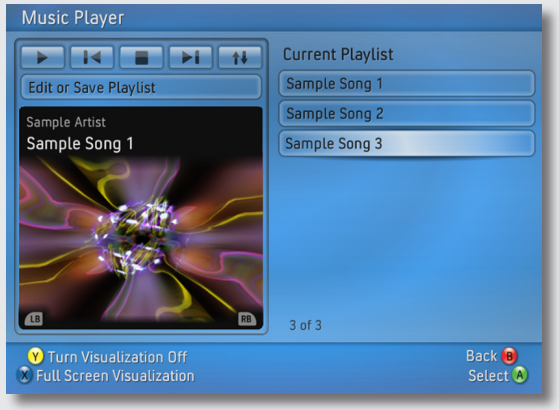
Playlist focus



Song 1 focus



Song 3 focus



TEXT ELEMENTS

Fonts / Flex buttons / Buttons / Meta panels

Fonts

Convection and Convection UI are the only fonts used throughout the interface.

The minimum font size is 24pt in Photoshop - or equivalent in Xui.

All text should be legible from a comfortable viewing distance - approximately 10ft.

Ensure there is a high contrast between the text Color and background Color to ensure legibility.

In the Dash a drop shadow is added to help text clarity. To add a drop in XUI, check the "Dropshadow" box in textStyle.

Dash:

Text Color	**R:**15	**G:**15	**B:**15	**A:**230
Drop Shadow	**R:**235	**G:**235	**B:**235	**A:**90

Guide:

Text Color	**R:**15	**G:**15	**B:**15	**A:**230

Convection

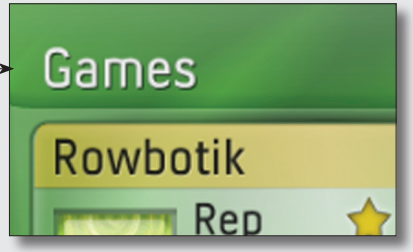
a b c d e f g h i j k l m n
o p q r s t u v w x y z
A B C D E F G H I J K L M N
O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Convection UI

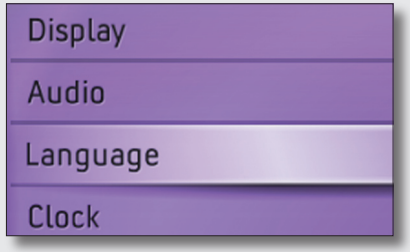
a b c d e f g h i j k l m n
o p q r s t u v w x y z
A B C D E F G H I J K L M N
O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Dash Text Sizes/Styles

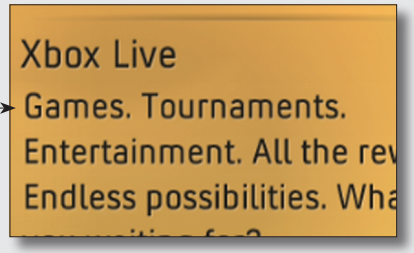
Screen heading
Convection UI,22 pt, drop shadow



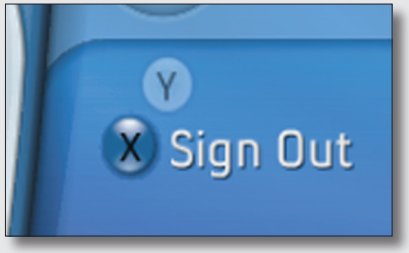
Text link
Convection, 18pt, drop shadow



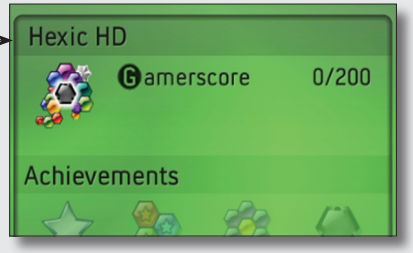
Body text/copy
Convection, 18pt, drop shadow



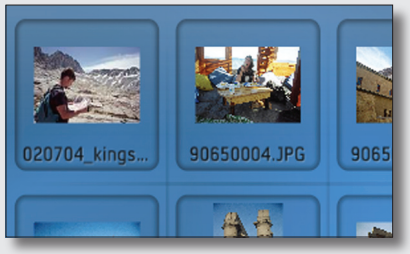
Legend
Convection, 16 pt, drop shadow



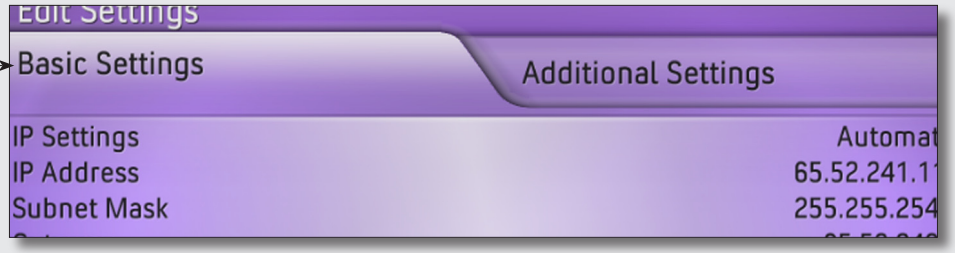
Meta panel header
Convection UI, 20pt, drop shadow



Pictures filename (SubText)
Convection UI, 12pt, drop shadow

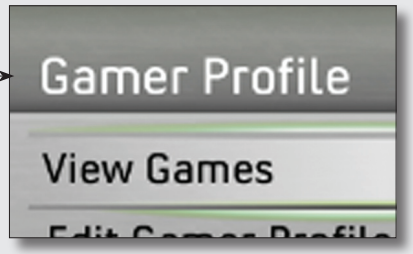


Selected / non-selected tab heading
Convection UI, 20pt, drop shadow



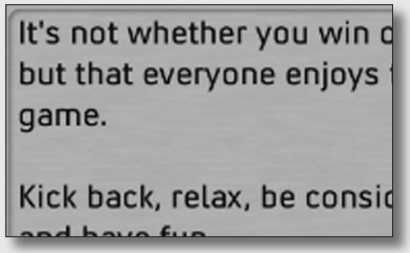
Guide Text Sizes/Style

Screen heading
Convection UI, 24 pt



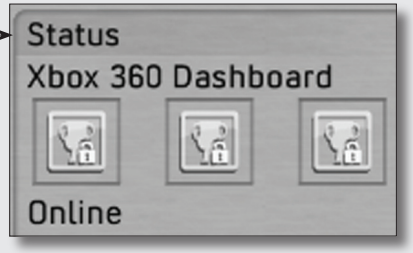
Text link
Convection UI, 20 pt

Body text/copy
Convection, 20 pt

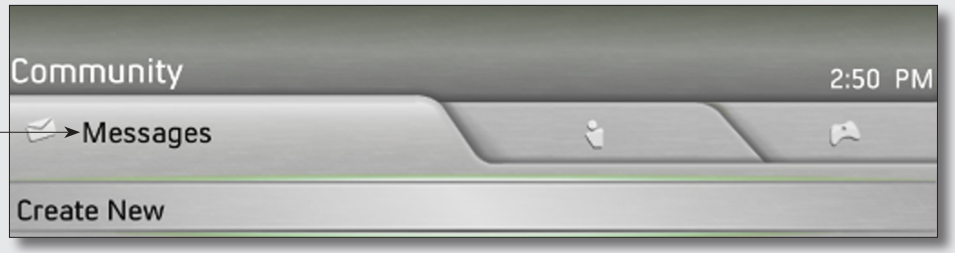


Legend
Convection, 18 pt

Meta panel header
Convection UI, 20 pt



Selected tab heading
Convection UI, 20 pt



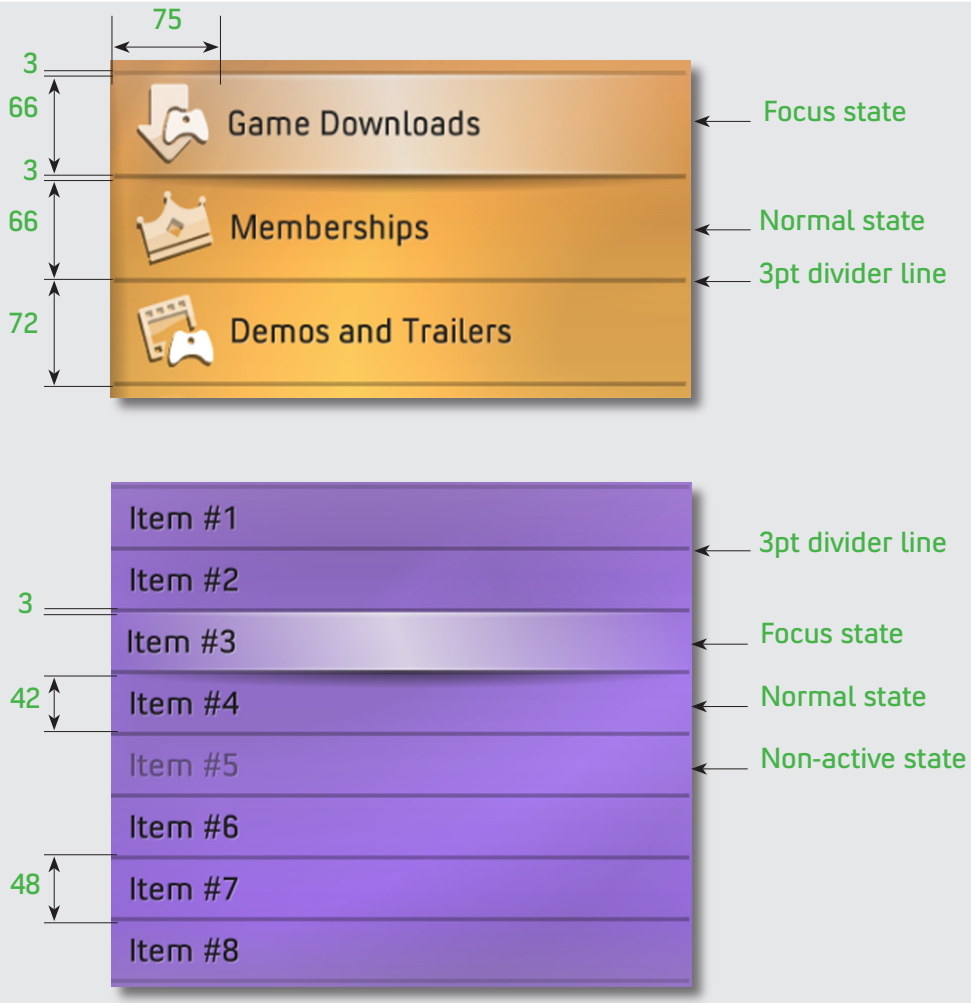
Dash Flex buttons

Flex buttons contain one to four lines of text.

They can also include an image tile - there are three size options for these.

The flex button's focus state uses a bottom shadow and white highlights to give the impression of popping out of the screen. The text and tile, where applicable, should also move two pixels to the left, to give the impression that it has scaled up.

When a text link is non-selectable it appears greyed-out. But it also has a focus state as you can still roll over it.

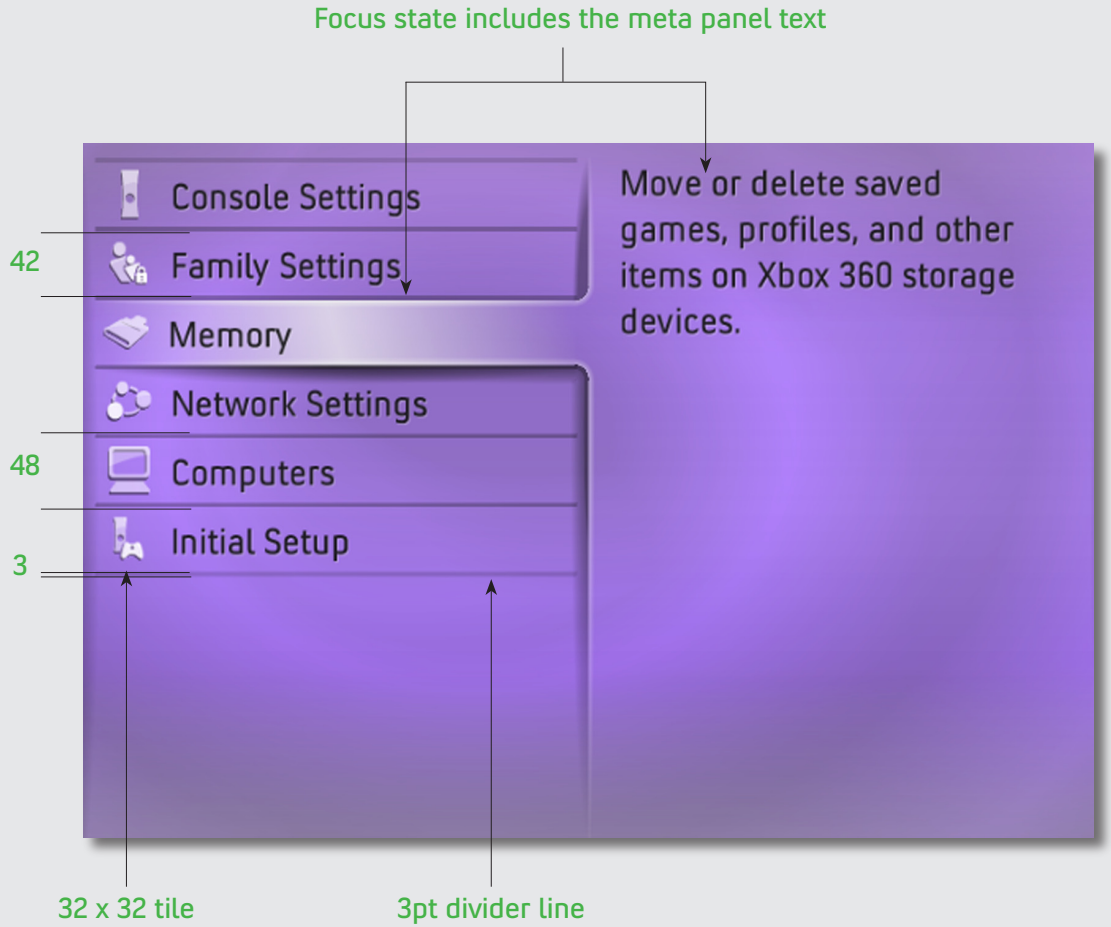


Meta-Flex buttons

Connected flex button and meta panel

A text link can appear alongside a meta panel where more content or information is displayed.

When these two items appear together they should always be connected in their focus state. In this instance the meta panel alone is active, you select the text link and meta panel combined.



Buttons

Buttons have a glass-like quality, created using shadows and highlights.

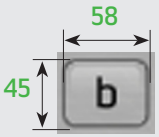
Copy within them should be kept to a minimum - with room being allowed for language localization.

If icons are used within the buttons, they should be as big and clear as possible.

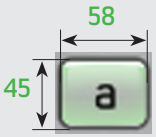
Guide Message center button (normal state)

Guide Message center button (focus state)

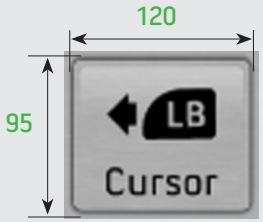
On-screen keyboard button 1



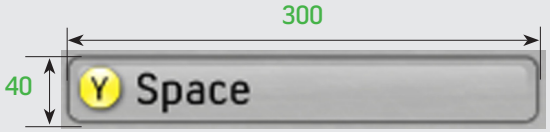
On-screen keyboard button 1 (focus state)



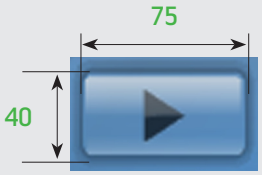
On-screen keyboard button 2



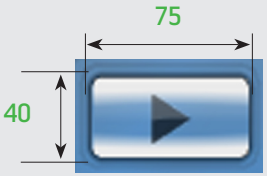
On-screen keyboard button 3



Dash Media player button



Dash Media player button (focus state)



Meta panels

Meta panels are areas that can contain text, icons, buttons and tiles. However, they should never be too crammed - the content should always have room to breathe. While the width is set by the grid, the height can be increased or decreased to suit the content.

They have rounded corners and have a translucent, glass-like look. The text should have at least a 3 pixel buffer within them.

Meta panels can sit independently within the grid, or can be connected to a text link. When using multiple meta panels in a scene there must be at least a 5 pixel space between them.

DESIGN ELEMENTS

Colors / Icons / Image Sizes

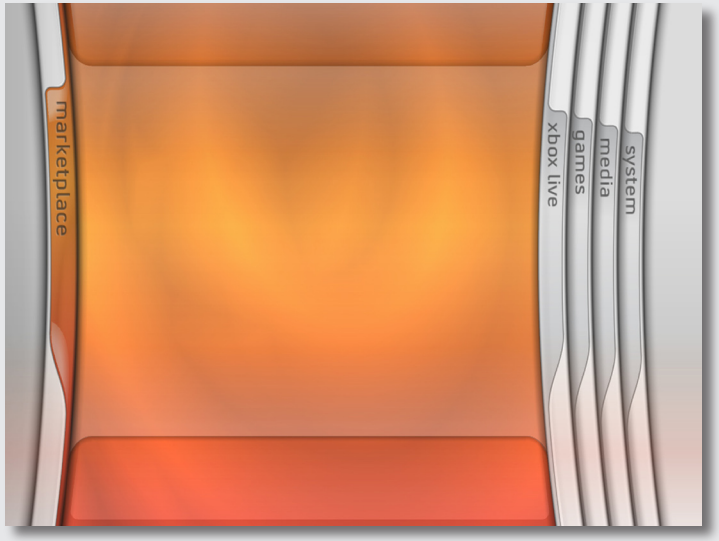
Colors

Each section is color-coded using the orange, blue, green, or purple from the Xui color palette. These colors help to make the interface feel more friendly, define the sections and aid navigation.

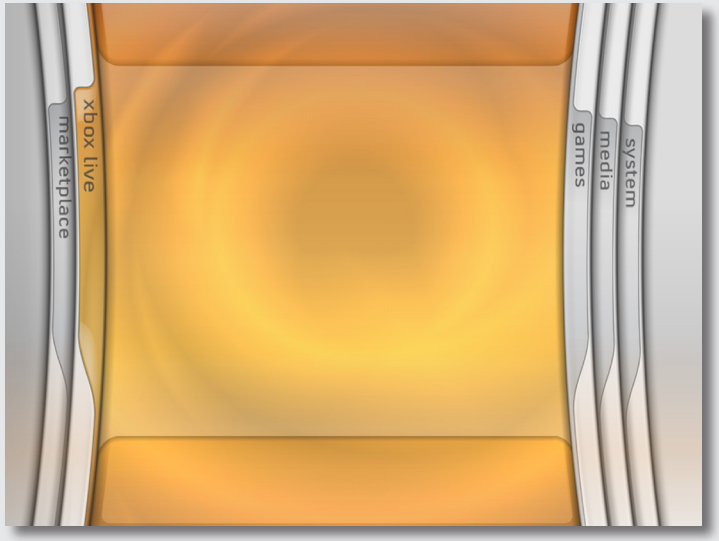
A section's Color should never change once assigned.

The main home/games page should be green, in keeping with the brand. It is recommended that the section most associated with Xbox Live be orange.

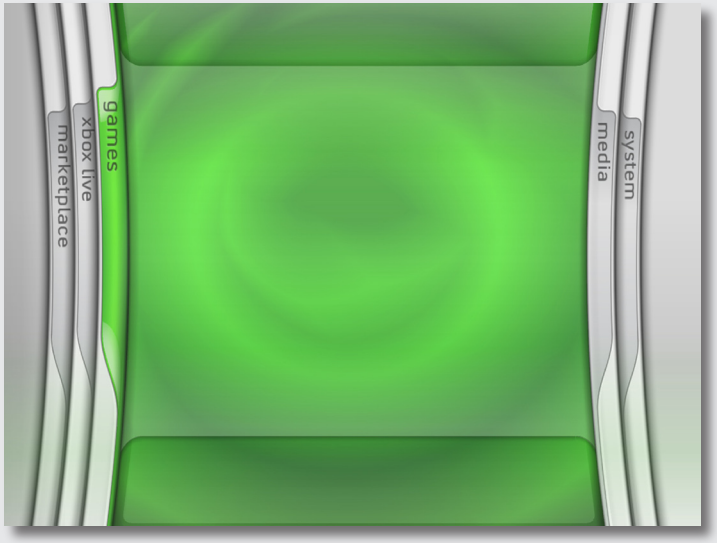
Red/Orange

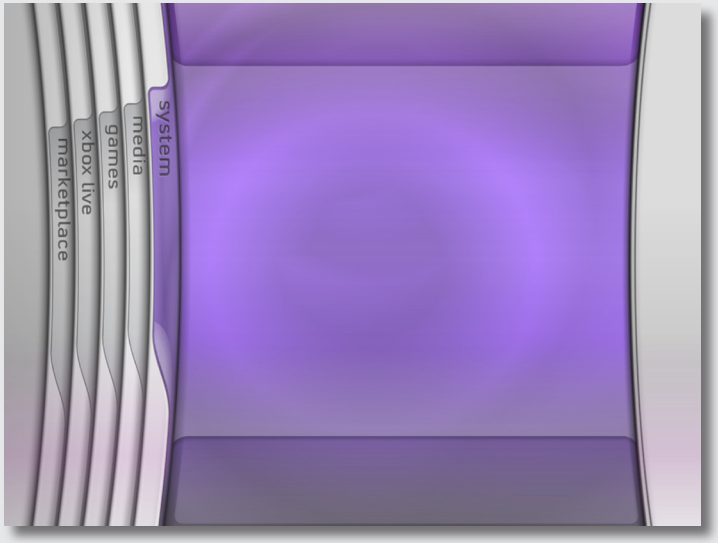


Orange



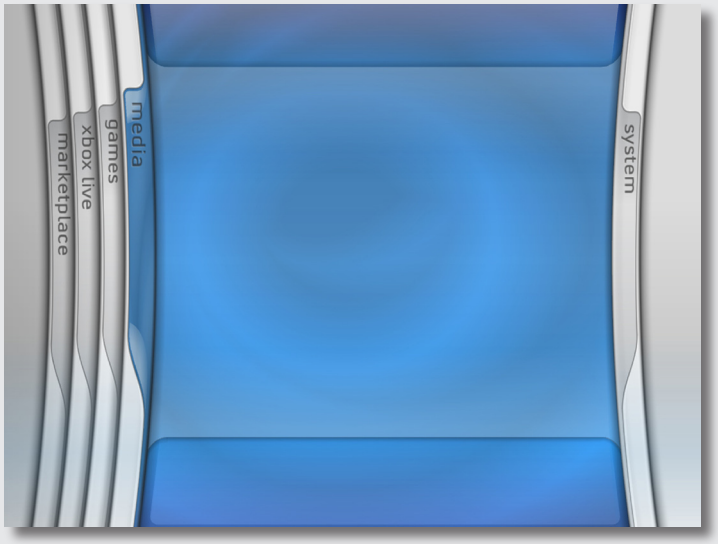
Green

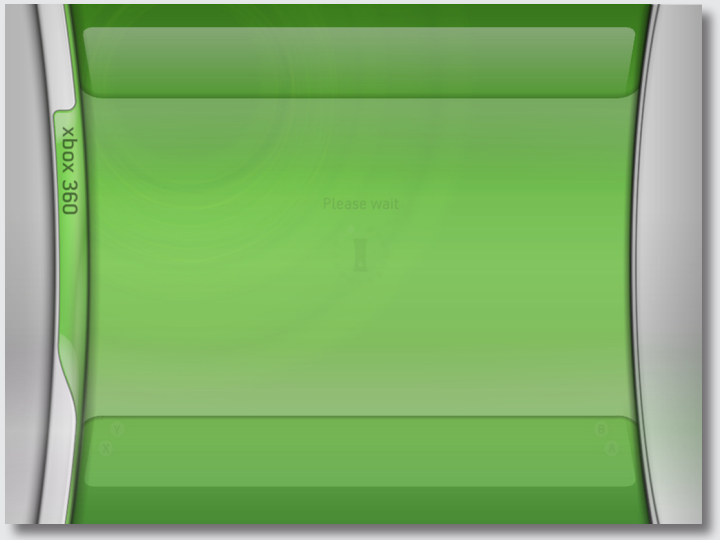




Purple

Blue





OOBE Green

Icons

Xbox 360's icon style is simple, sophisticated, and easy to read on a TV screen. Each icon is rendered in a vector program and then manipulated in Adobe Photoshop to produce a transparent PNG format.

These guidelines are geared towards designers. It is recommend you work with a good graphic designer, especially one with experience in using vector programs to create images.

Icon Style Characteristics

- Angle provide a dynamic energy to the images.
- Edges and corners of elements are slightly rounded.
- Light source is coming from the top creating a subtle glass reflection effect.
- A drop shadow provides contrast and dimension.

Icon Sizes

There are three sizes of Xbox 360 icons:

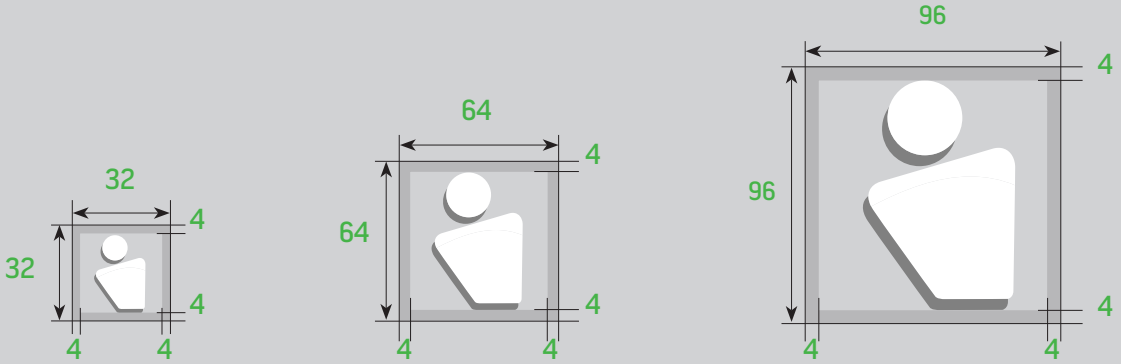
- 96 × 96 pixels
- 64 × 64 pixels
- 32 × 32 pixels

* There is a 4 pixel buffer area included in total size (see "icon sizes" to the right).

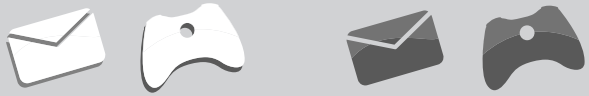
There are two colors of Xbox 360 icons:

- Black
- white (with dark gray drop shadow)

Icon Sizes



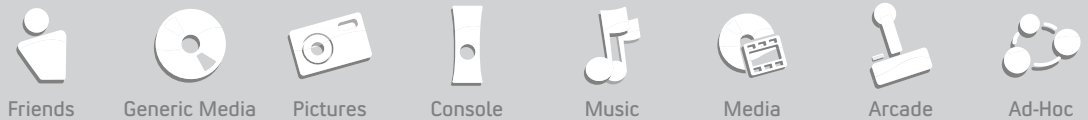
Icon Colors



White

Black

Icon Examples



Friends | Generic Media | Pictures | Console | Music | Media | Arcade | Ad-Hoc

Chat | MU | Unlock | USB | Recent Player | Sound | Wired Controller | Hard Drive

Icon Creation

STEP BY STEP ICON CREATION

MAIN SHAPE

1. Draw the main shape icon in Illustrator or Freehand
2. Rotate icon 15 Degrees
3. Change Opacity to 50%

SHADOW (only on white icons)

4. Copy main image to create shadow.
5. Change color to black
6. Change black opacity to 50%
7. Lower the copy shape a couple of pixels
8. Select both shapes
9. In Pathfinders, click divide to break the shadow shape apart.
10. Delete the shape behind the main shape, leaving only the shadow part.

GLASS REFLECTION EFFECT

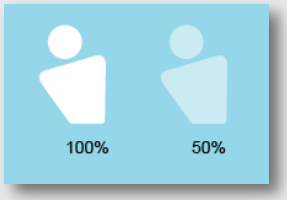
11. Create glass reflection effect on top of the main shape using white color.
12. Change reflection opacity to 35% on WHITE icon, 15% on BLACK icon.

TRANSFER TO PHOTOSHOP

13. Group individual icons
14. Select and copy
15. Paste into PSD file with transparent background
14. Save file to transparent PNG

Icon Creation Steps (referenced on left)

Step 3: 50% Opacity



Step 9: Drop Shadow pathfinder (divide)

Step 10: Drop Shadow

Image Sizes

Image tiles can be used within panels and flex buttons.

Images should be good quality and cropped in an interesting, dynamic way.

32x32 size

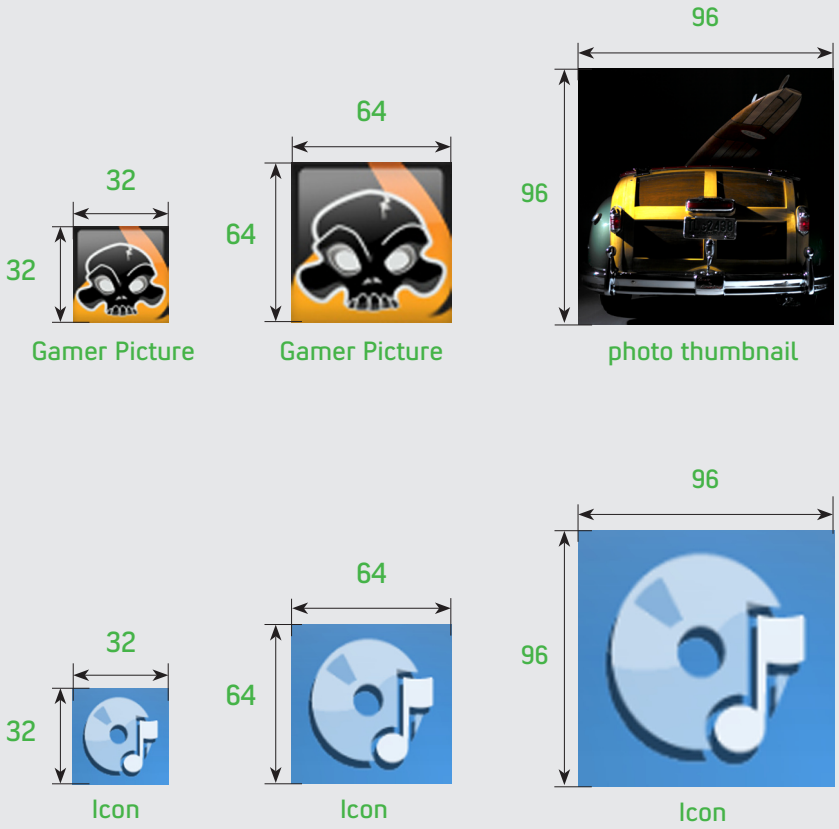
Used in straight list template. Could be an image or an icon.

64x64 size

Used in double line buttons and Gamer Pictures. Could be an image or an icon.

96x96 size

Used in photo thumbnail and meta icons.



LOADERS

Style / Size / Animation

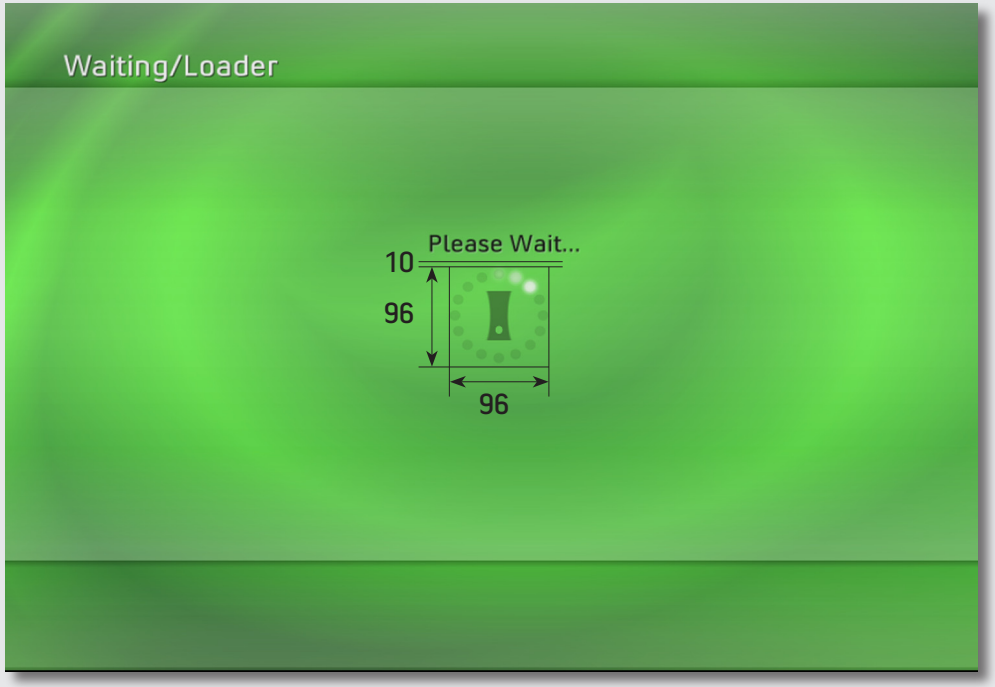
Loader

There are two styles of loaders/progress indicators used through out the UI.

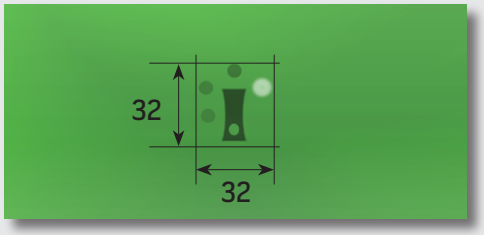
1. Waiting Loaders

- Used when the amount of time in wait is unknown.
- There is a larger loader (pictured top right) and a smaller in-line loader (bottom right).
- Large Loader (96x96 px) is used when waiting on an entire page content and/or when aesthetically fitting.
- In-line Loaders (32x32 px) is used when loading or waiting on portions of a page and/or when aesthetically fitting.
- Dash waiting loaders should use a white highlight on the outer dot animation. (example on the right)
  White RGB: R=255, B=255, G=255
- Guide waiting loaders should use a green highlight on the outer dot animation. (example on next page)
  GreenRGB: R=176, G=220, B=53

Large Waiting Loader (dash)



In-Line Waiting Loader (dash)

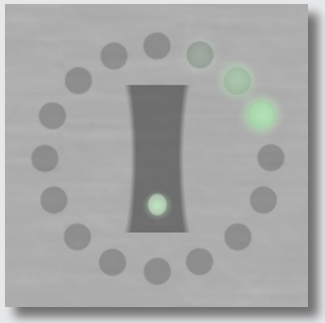


Loader

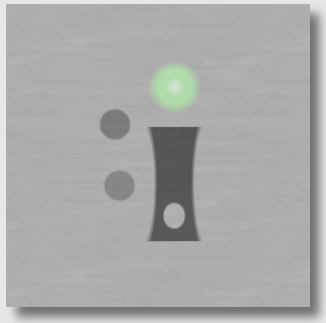
Examples of waiting loaders

Waiting Large Dash
96x96 pixels

Waiting In-line Dash
32x32 pixels



Waiting Large Guide
96x96 pixels



Waiting In-line Guide
32x32 pixels

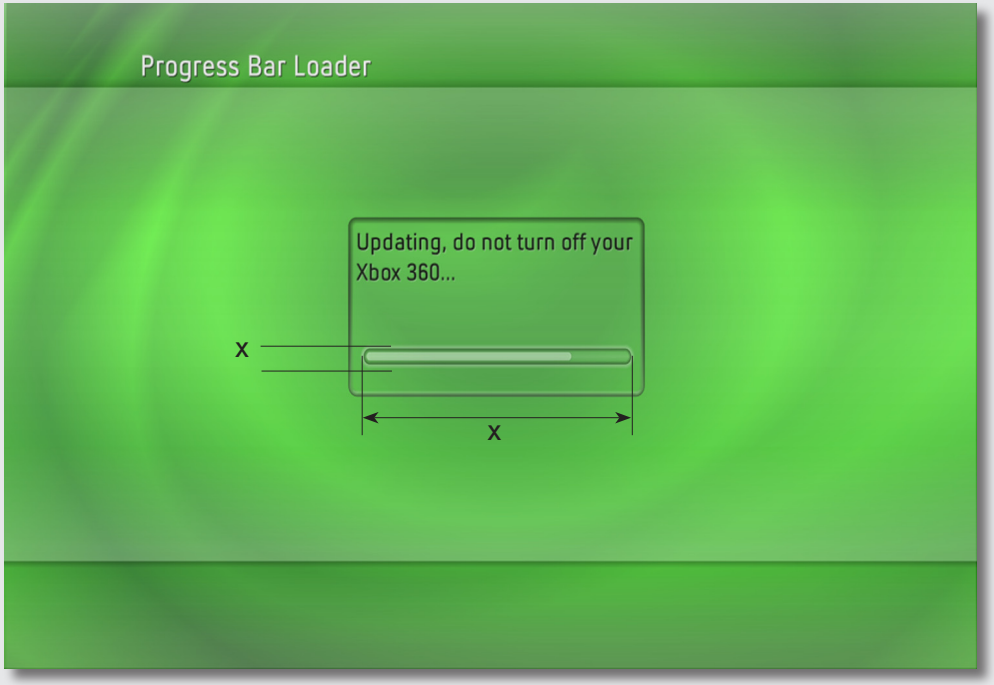
Loader

There are two styles of loaders/progress indicators used through out the UI.

2. Progress Bar Loaders

- Used when the amount of time in wait is known.
- Progress bar loaders can be variable widths and heights to fit as needed.
- Dash progress bar loaders should use a white highlight on the bar animation. (example on the right)
  White RGB: R=255, B=255, G=255, A= 225
- Guide progress bar loaders should use a green highlight on the bar animation. (example on next page)
  GreenRGB: R=176, G=220, B=53 A=2

Progress Bar Loader (dash)



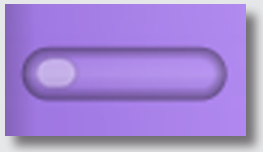
In-line Progress Bar loader (dash)

Loader

Examples of Progress Bar Loaders

Progress Bar Loader Dash
Variable Length/height

Memory Capacity Bar Loader Dash
Variable Length/height



Progress Bar Loader Guide
Variable Length/height

Memory Capacity Bar Loader Guide
Variable Length/height

TEMPLATES

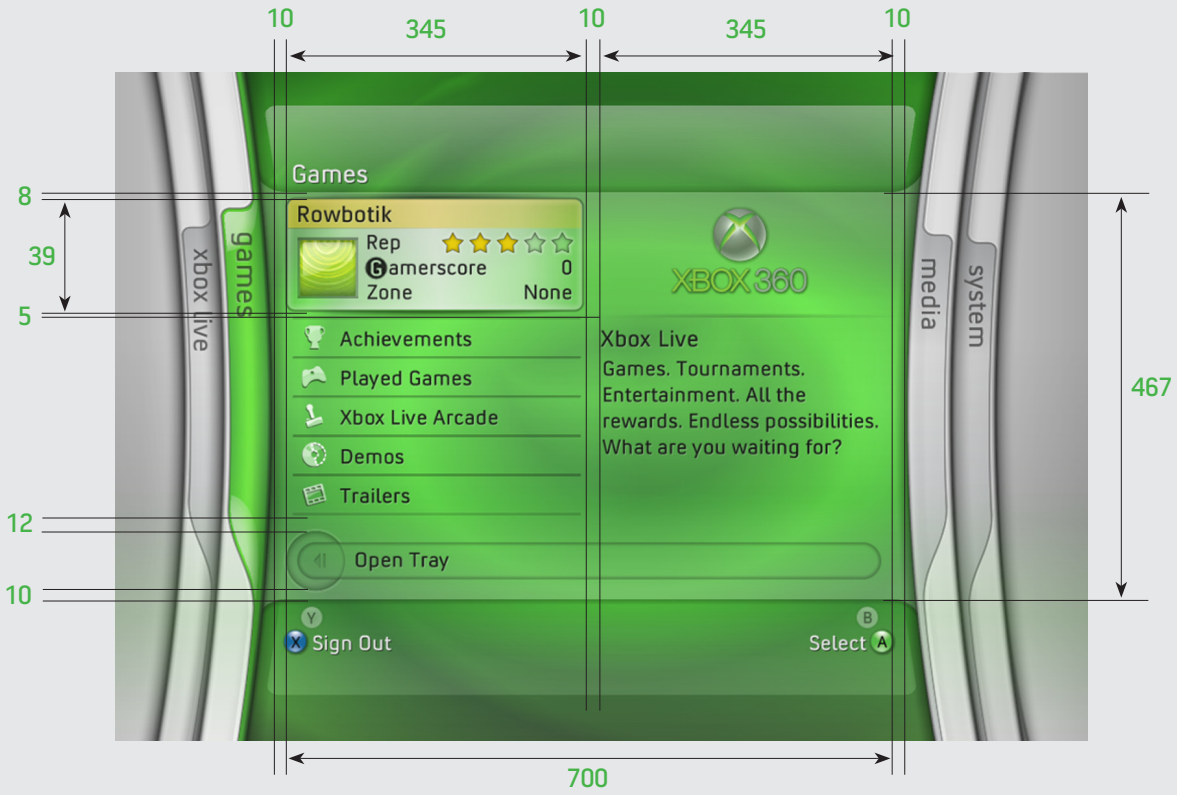
Live / Games / Media / System / Double line / Straight list / TwoTab / Image selector / Descriptive text / Left list / Media player / Individual song

Live Blade

This is the template for the Live Blade layout.
(4-blade top level, note that the current dash uses 5-blades. The template and content area remains the same as the 4-blade screen.)

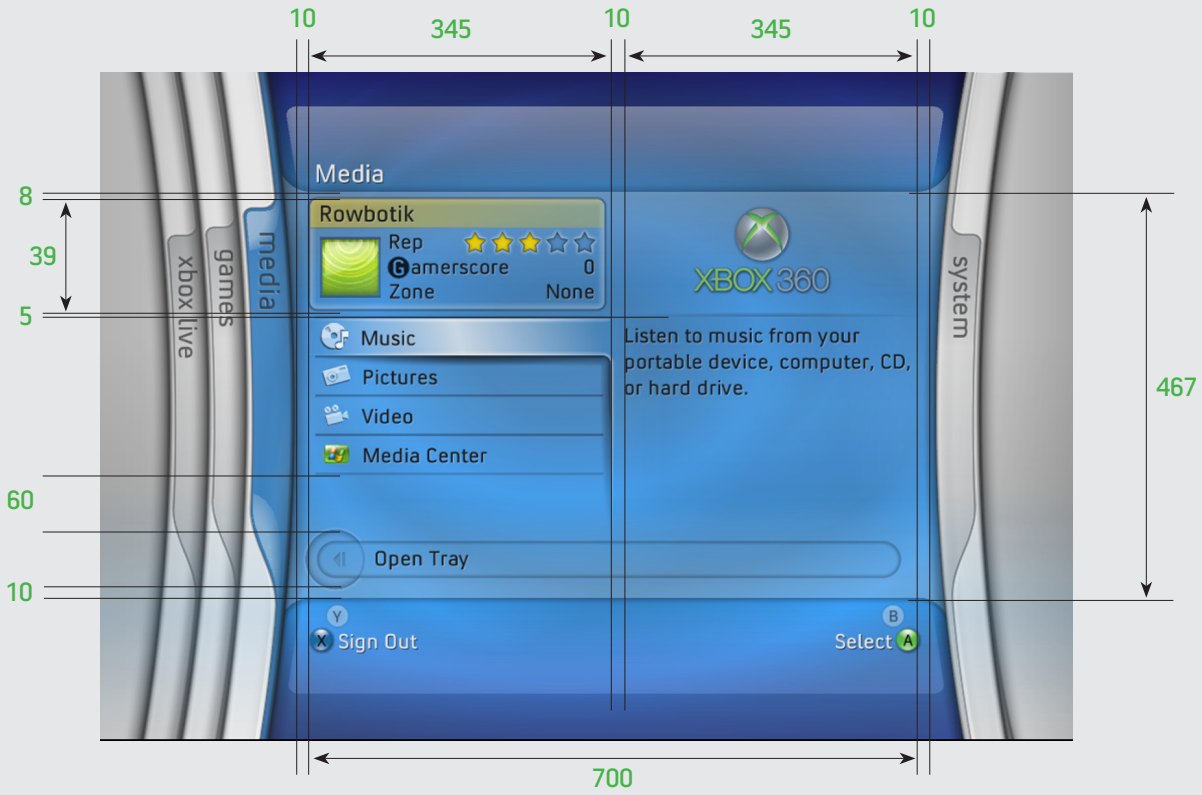
Games Blade

This is the template for the Games Blade layout.
(4-blade top level, note that the current dash uses 5-blades. The template and content area remains the same as the 4-blade screen.)



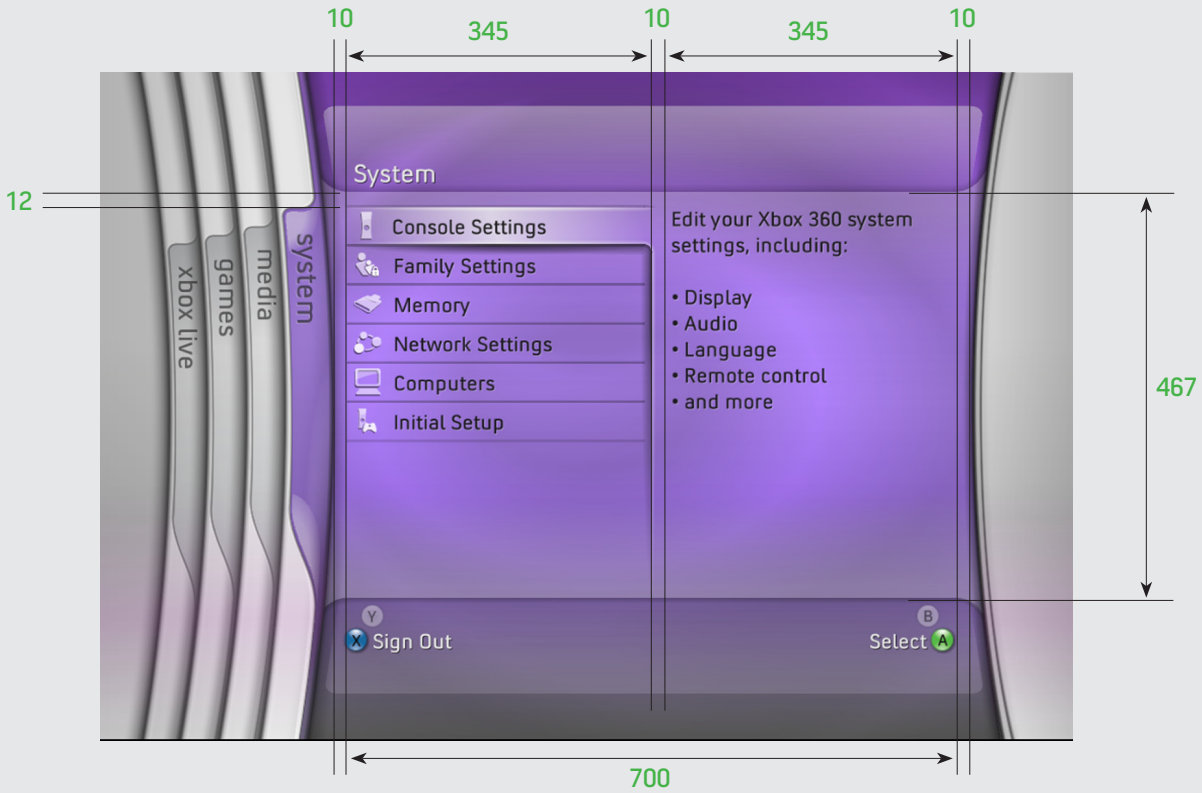
Media Blade

This is the template for the Media Blade layout.
(4-blade top level, note that the current dash uses 5-blades. The template and content area remains the same as the 4-blade screen.)



System Blade

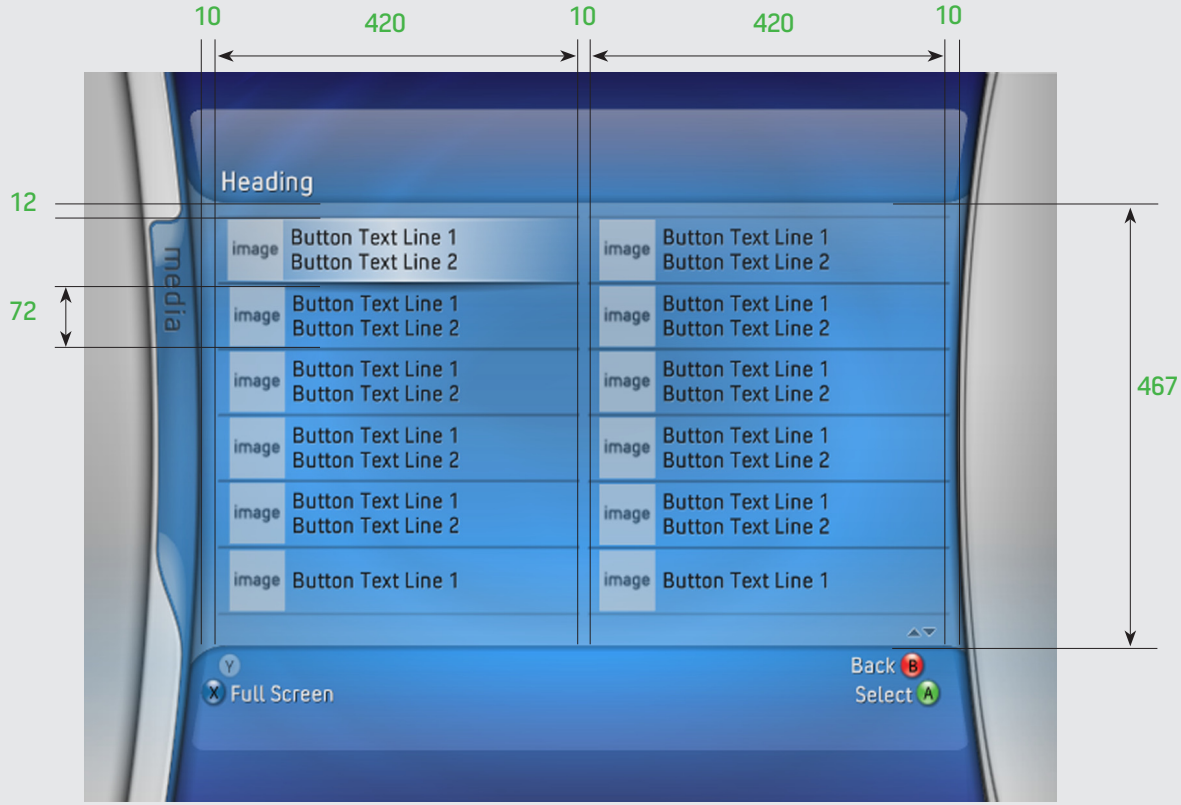
This is the template for the System Blade layout.
(4-blade top level, note that the current dash uses 5-blades. The template and content area remains the same as the 4-blade screen.)



Double line (12 items)

This is the template for a screen with 12 double-line flex buttons with image tiles.
(2nd and 3rd level)

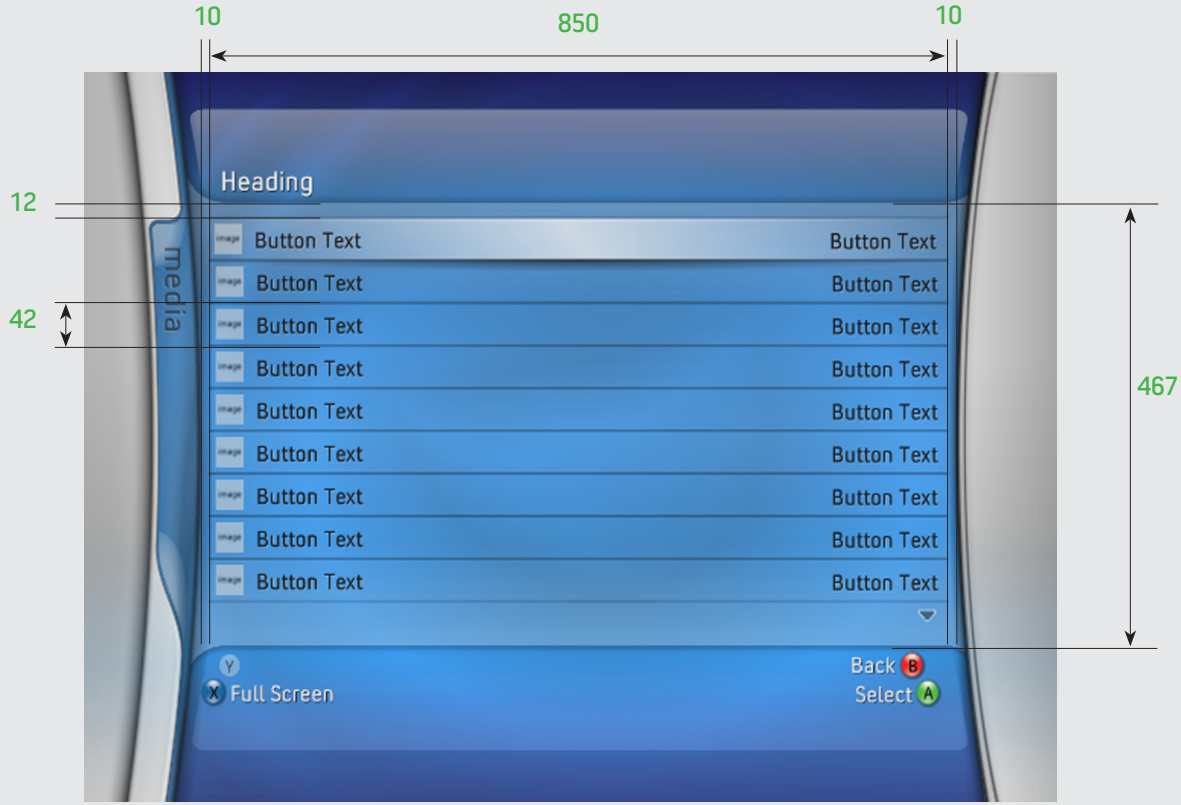
(Also see Grid Navigation on pg. 16)



Straight list

This is the template for a screen with a straight list of flex buttons with image tiles.
(2nd and 3rd level)

(Also see Full Width Column Navigation on pg. 15)

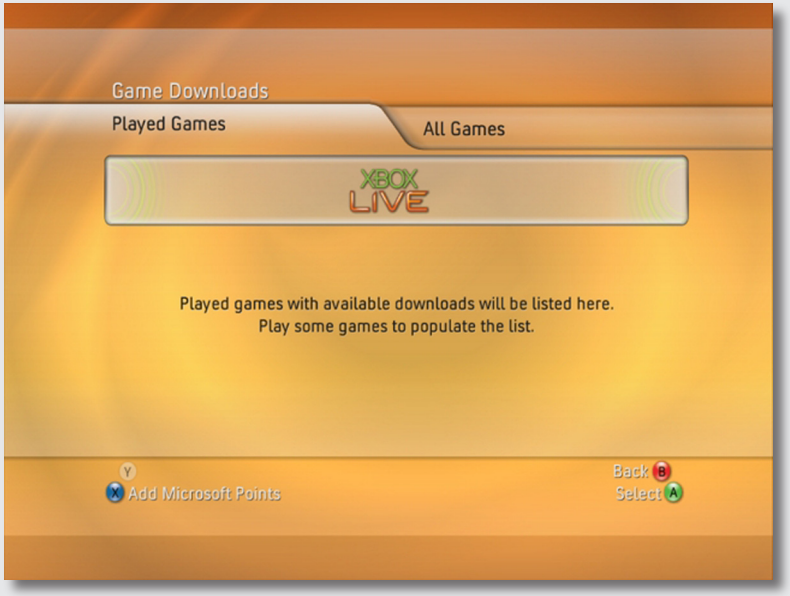


Two-Tab

This is the template for a dash Tab Scene, it could contain different variations of buttons with the option of image/icon tiles, split into two tabbed sections.
(dash 2nd level)

Two-Tab

Left tab focus



Right tab focus

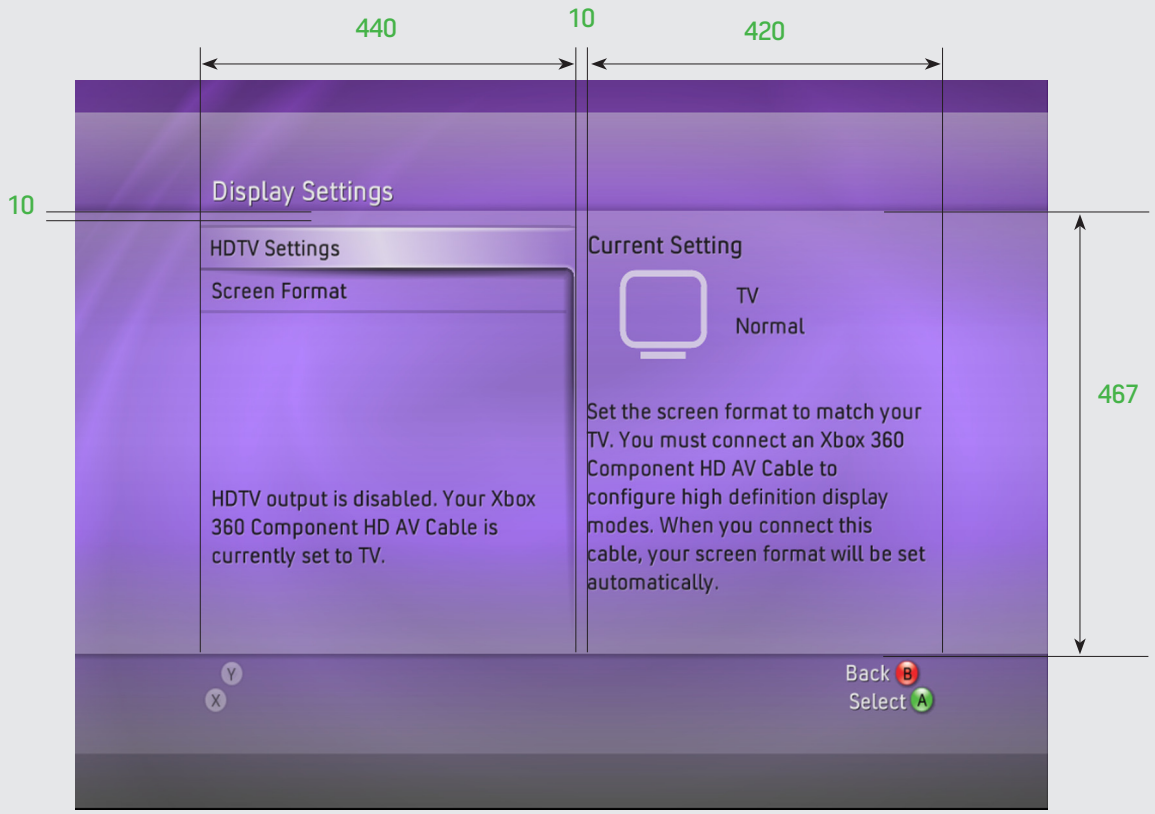
Image selector

This is the template for an image selector screen. The right side is a vertically scrolling 3x3 grid of selectable image thumbnails.

(3rd level)

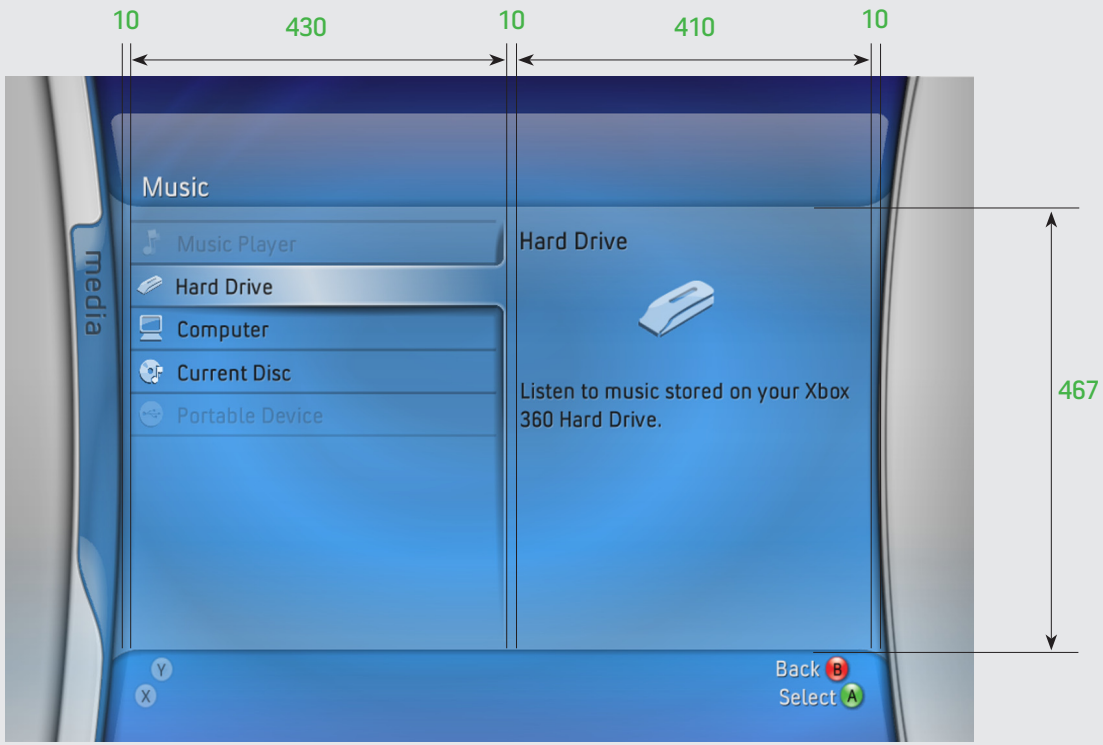
Descriptive text

This is the template for a screen that features non-selectable descriptive text and a left-hand list of single flex buttons with image tiles and meta panels.
(2nd and 3rd level)



Left list

This is the template for a screen with a left-hand list of single flex buttons with image tiles and meta panels.
(Top,2nd, and 3rd level)

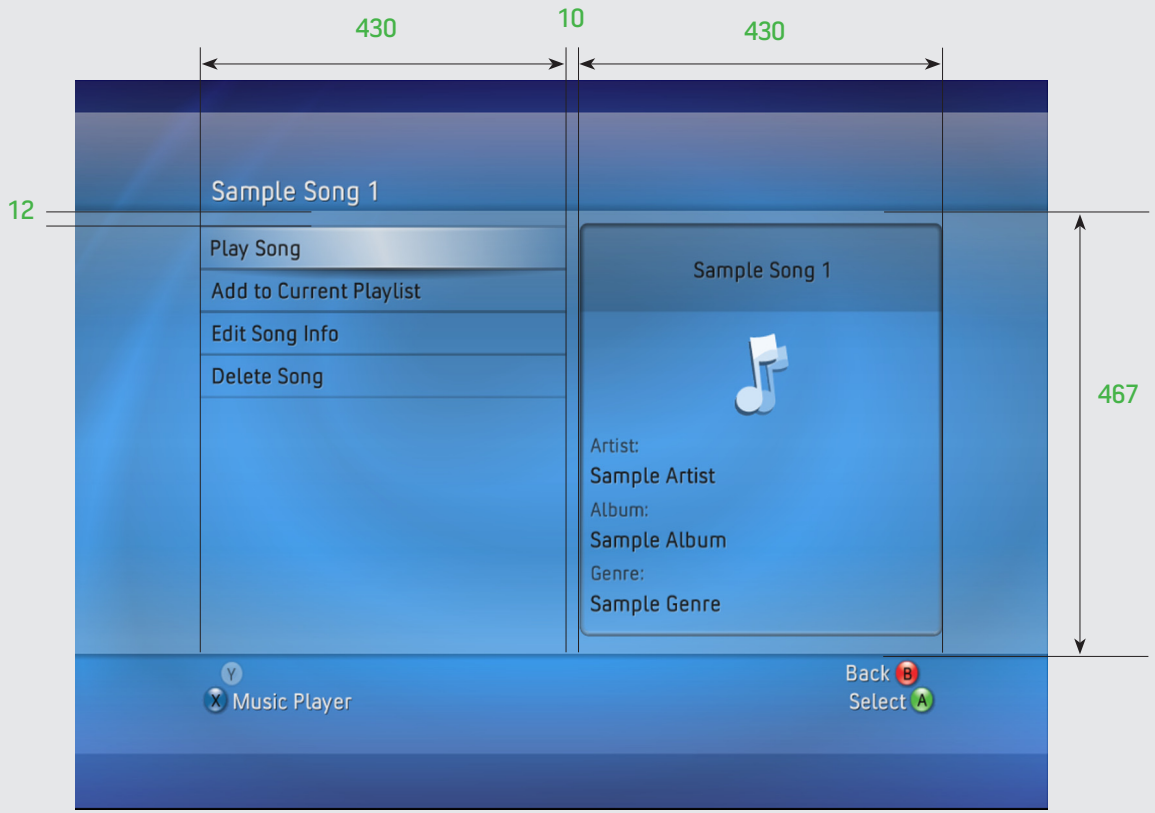


Media player

This is the template for a media player screen.
(3rd level, media blade)

Individual song

This is the template for a media player individual track screen.
(3rd level, media blade)



Guide

Guide look and feel / Guide Home / Guide gamer picture selector / Guide tabbed / Notification

Guide look and feel

With the exception of a few half width Guide screens, all Guide (Full width) and DASH (2nd/3rd level) screens use the same content templates as the main interface.

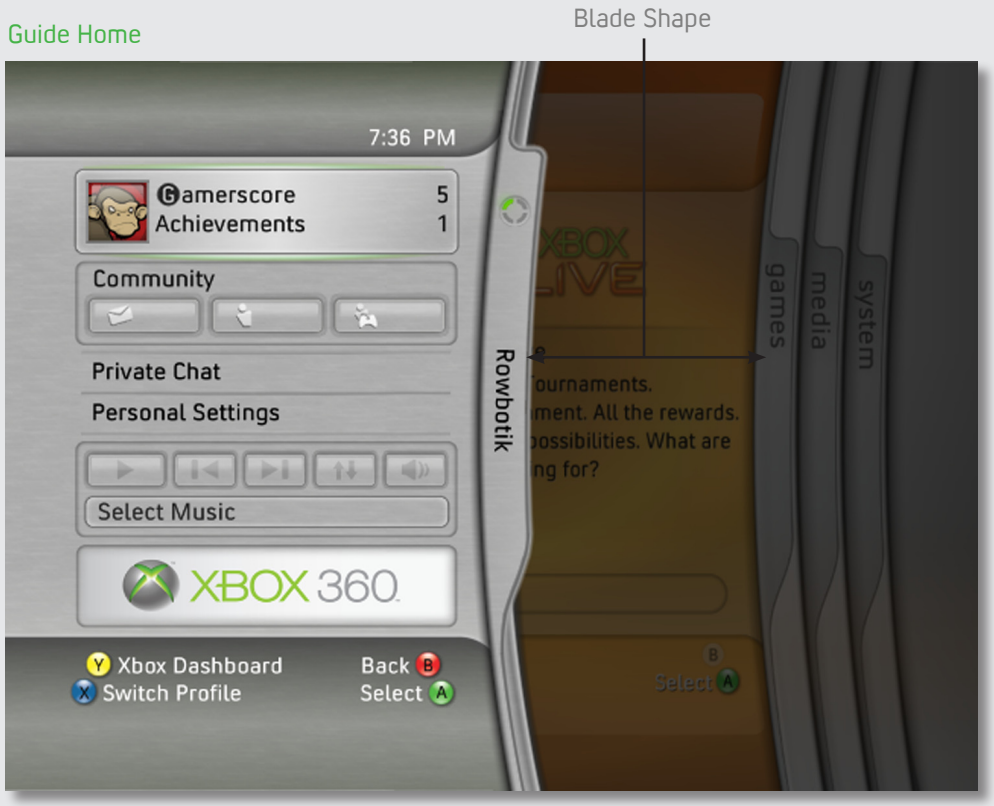
The Guide screens are designed to be as non-intrusive as possible. And because they can be accessed from anywhere, they have to work on a number of backgrounds, eg a game or movie.

The Guide has a steel-like, metal quality. The Guide does not use the same highlight Colors as the Dash interface. Instead they appear in whites and greens so as not to conflict with the background. However, the content should always be clearly visible and legible.

The Guide's form is based on a reverse cutout of the Dash blades. The Guide's blade shape is based on the Jewel section of the Dash blade. (example: compare games blade and Guide blade on Guide homepage image)

The Ring of Light is featured on every screen within the Guide. Located on the top right of the Guide blade. It is has four quadrants which light up in different Colors to notify different circumstances.

Guide Home



Guide Home Template

Guide Home

This is the template for the Guide Home, revealed when the Xbox 360 button on the controller is selected. It uses just one column with grid like navigation.

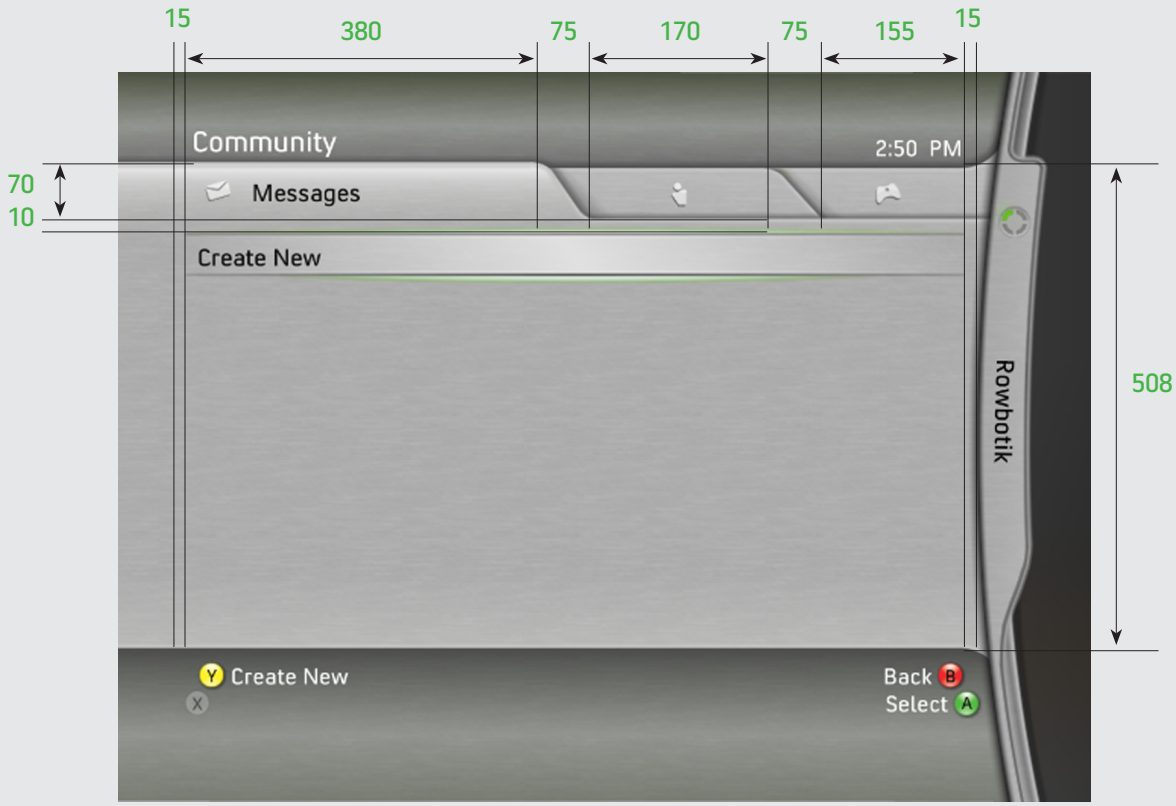
Guide Home

Guide Home

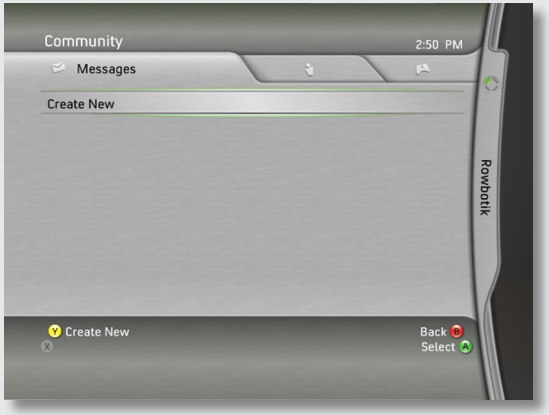
Guide Home on different backgrounds

Community

This is the template for community section, it could contain ten single-line flex buttons with option of image/icon tiles, split into three tabbed sections.
(Guide)



Messages Tab

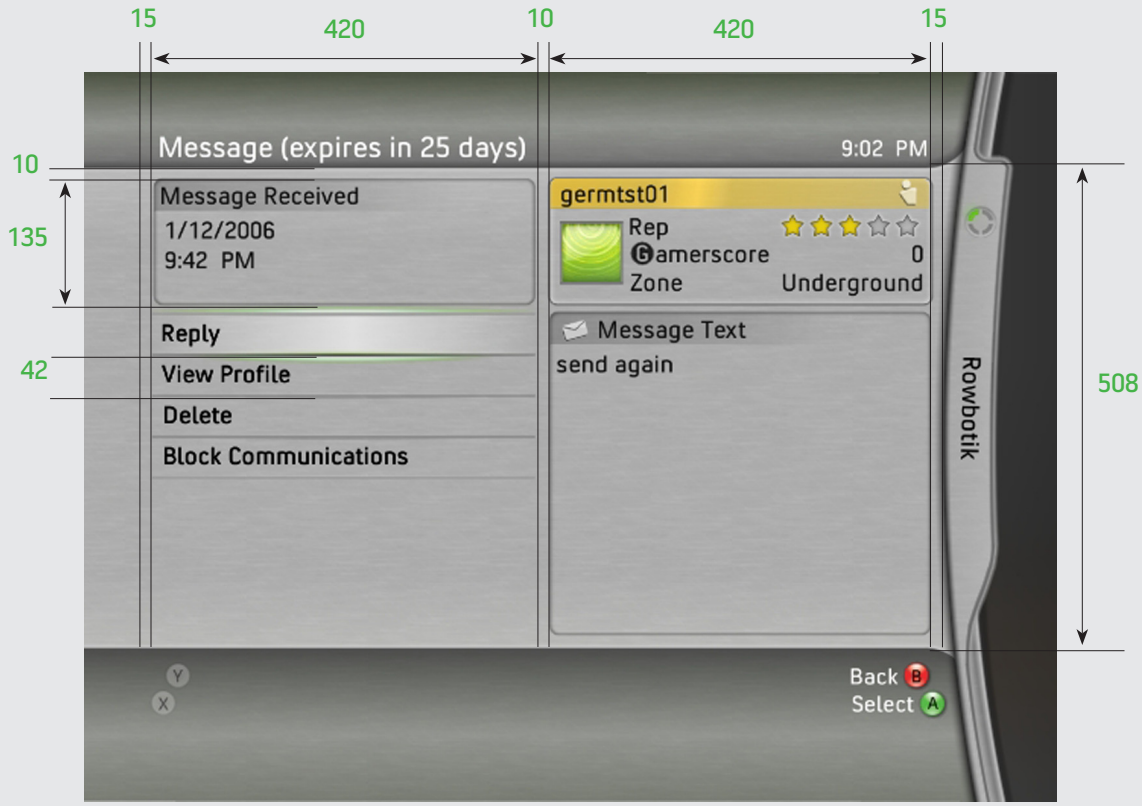


Friends Tab

Recent Players Tab

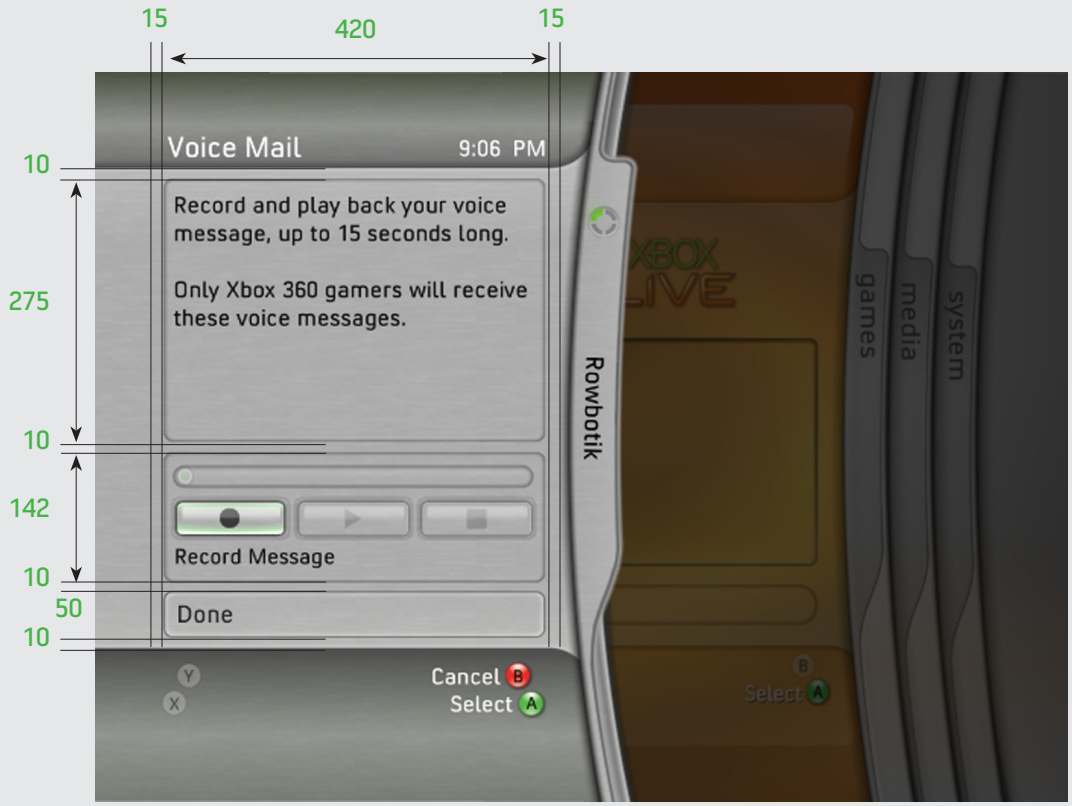
Read Message

This is the template for the read message screen.
(Guide)



Voice Message

This is the template for the record voice message screen.
(Guide)



On-screen keyboard

This is the template for the on-screen keyboard.
(Guide)

Gamer Picture Select

This is the template for the Gamer Picture Select screen. The left side is a vertically scrolling 4x4 grid of selectable gamer pictures.

Notification

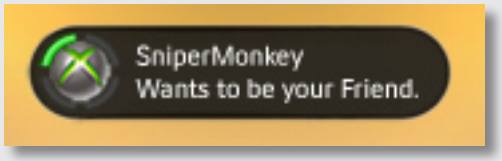
The notifications appear in a dark grey/black color so as not to conflict with the background.

All notifications are contained within the lozenge shape. While the height of this is set, the length should be dynamic to fit its content.

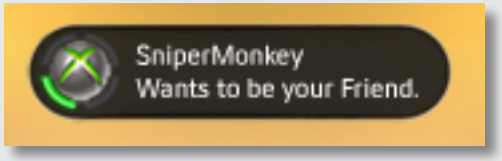
The ring of light (ROL) has four quadrants. When the notification appears one of the four will be lit green indicating which player the message is for. Also the Core logo in the center of the ROL will cross fade with an icon associated with the type of message.

Different quadrants highlighted

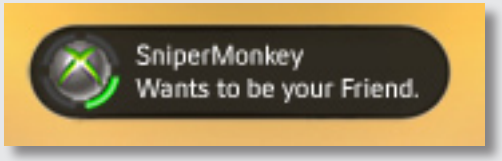
Top Left



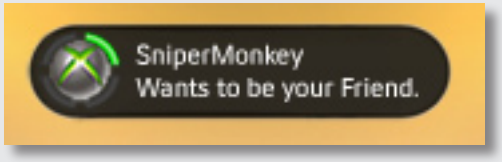
Bottom Left



Bottom Right

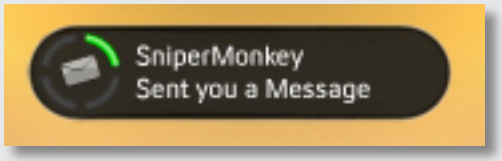


Top Left

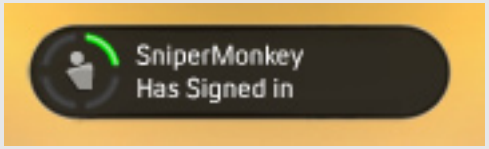


ROL Center Icon Examples

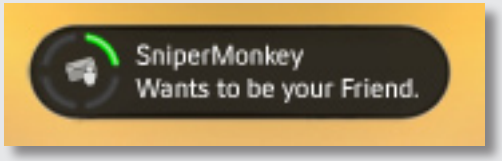
New Message



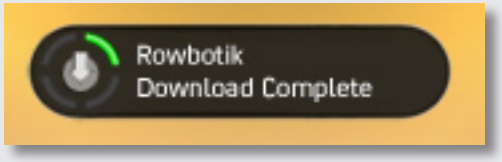
Friend Online



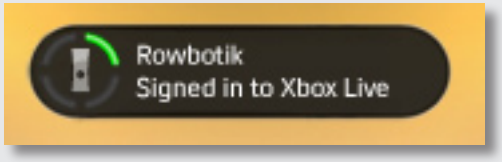
Friend Invite



Download Complete



Signed In



SOUND

Guidelines / Specs

Sound

The concept for the sound is the Core. The Core is an energy centre that has infinite power and magnetic pull. The sound should be a power waiting to be unleashed - an energy which drives the Xbox experience. This will help tie together the Core concept - especially when combined with the explosive boot sequence (an implosion) where all the energy and power are sucked into and contained behind the screen and in the box.

This Core sound should be a defining feature of the whole soundscape. It should form part of this very powerful brand experience - think of the choir in the Halo interface.

Within each section, the Core appears in a different state. The sound should do the same. So when each section shows the Core to be different visually, it should also sound different.

The sound for buttons and the navigation should represent their visual personality. For example, the blades should 'swoosh' as they move from left to right, and the buttons should pulse into life.

All sounds should be in keeping with the visual look and feel. They should have the same characteristics as the animation:

- organic
- fluid
- light
- living
- energy
- futuristic
- otherworldly

The sound should never be:

- clunky
- mechanical
- rigid
- harsh
- dark

XBOX 360™

CONTENT STYLE GUIDE

General principles

Designing for TV

There are a few basic principles that should be considered when designing interfaces for interactive TV.

- Keep it simple. Viewers don't read TV screens. Keep text short and to a minimum.
- Keep it big. Small graphics and thin lines don't render well on TV and are best avoided.
- Design from a distance. Remember viewers are not seeing the screen up close, so content needs to be large and clear enough to be viewed from a comfortable distance.
- Easy navigation. It has to be simple and intuitive.

Colors on TV

- TV-safe Colors must be used to avoid visual disturbances.
- Avoid saturated Colors in areas of small detail. While Colored backgrounds are used, they need to be carefully considered so that the Colors remain TV legal.
- Keep the 'Y' values of text and background as far apart as possible.

Safe area

- Keep content within the safe viewing area.
- Fit content within the page and avoid scrolling.
- Horizontal single lines must be a minimum of three pixels high to avoid flicker.

Aspect ratio

Templates have been designed to fit both 16:9 and 4:3 aspect ratios. It does this by either stretching or cropping or both. Each template is 1120 x 720 pixels and title safe is 590 x 955 pixels. Title safe should therefore be accurately observed as it addresses both of these aspect ratios.

Poster and Box Art Images

a. Master Source Images

Poster and game box art images are required for all Movie, TV Series, TV Seasons, TV Episode content. and Games. Submitted Poster and box art images should conform to the following specification:

i. Movie Poster :
   1. Format: PNG-24
   2. Dimensions: 584 x 800 (px)
   3. Resolution: 72dpi

ii. TV Series. Season, or Episode Poster
   1. Format: PNG-24
   2. Dimensions: 800 x 800 (px)
   3. Resolution: 72dpi

iii. Game Box Art :
   1. Format: PNG-24
   2. Dimensions: 584 x 800 (px)
   3. Resolution: 72dpi

   * This is worldwide box art, so the image supplied should work in all regions.

b. Actual Usage

Poster and game box art images will be displayed in content list and detail scene UIs throughout the Xbox 360 marketplace

i. Content List Item

Poster image is displayed in a 64 x 64 image presenter aligned to the left side of each item in a content list.

Maximum display area is 64 x 64 (px). When displayed in a list UI, the image will be scaled so that the pixel size of its height or width (whichever is greater) will equal 64 px. The original aspect ratio of the image will be maintained.

Embedded Content Tile

Content List screen

Poster and Box Art Images

ii. Meta Panel

Poster and game box art images will be used in meta panels in Content Lists and Details Scenes thoughout Xbox 360 marketplace and library.

Poster and game box images are displayed in a 200 x 200 image presenter located in the item's meta panel, aligned left under the meta header. This meta panel is present in content lists and details scenes.

Maximum display area is 200 x 200. When displayed in the UI, the image will be scaled so that the pixel size of its height or width (whichever is greater) will equal 100 px. The original aspect ratio of the image will be maintained.

Meta Panel Details Image

Meta Panel Details Image

TV Network/Provider Images

a. Master Source Images

Network/Provider images are required for all networks or providers that provide content to the video service. Submitted network/provider images should conform to the following specifications:

i. Format: PNG-24
ii. Dimensions: 800 x 504 (px)
iii. Resolution: 72dpi

b. Actual Usage

Network and studio images are displayed in the TV network/studio grid list located in the Network TV UI. For each list item, the network/provider image is displayed in a rounded corner button container. The maximum\actaul display area is 200 x 126 px. The original aspect ratio of the image will be maintained.

TV Network Image

Wallpaper Background Guidelines

Background Creation

Background files need to be **created** at 1120x770 in either .jpg or .png format.

Image Testing

For testing files, use the provided WallpaperTemplate.PSD file. Resize your working image to 1120 x 770. Replace the existing image in the correct blade layer with your resized background.

Best Practices:

i. Avoid using extremely light or dark colors, especially white and black, as they interfere with the text's readability

ii. Avoid using very saturated red/orange colors, as they tend to 'buzz' on standard definition televisions

iii. Avoid using thin lines of very dark colors alternating with thin lines of very light colors, as this also tends to 'buzz' on standard definition televisions

iv. Keep all critical visual information out of the 'Potential Lost Area' (a layer appearing in the photoshop file...make sure to hide this layer before exporting your background)

i.a

i.b

ii.

iii.

iv.

Wallpaper Background Guidelines

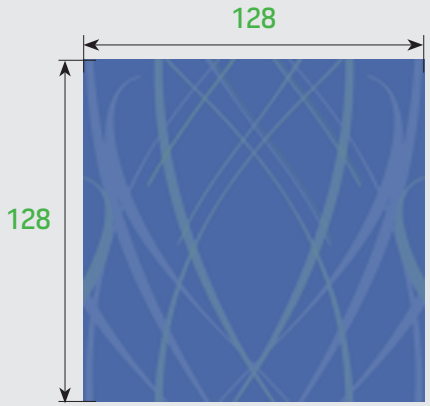
Logo Placement

A logo can be placed anywhere in the background (refer to the test WallpaperTemplate.PSD to make sure your logo doesn't come in contact with the 'Potential Lost Areas').
A 'Logo Safe Area' also appears in the test file. If the network logo is placed inside this area, it will appear above the Dashboard content panel, acting as a screen header.

Guide Themes

A Guide Texture is a 128x128 tile in 8-bit png format. The guide has white icons and highlights, as well as black and white text, and the guide textures must not compete with either element.
No text elements or logos are to be used in the textures as they interfere with the legibility of the guide.
Keep in mind TV safe ranges for all colors.

Theme Background File



Default Guide Texture

Hot Rod Theme Guide Texture

Gamer Pictures

To create Gamer Pictures:

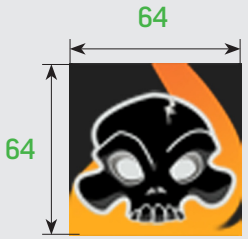
-crop image to 64x64

-insert image into the last layer of the provided 'gamerPicture.psd' file

-do not use transparent backgrounds, the 64x64 image must be completely opaque

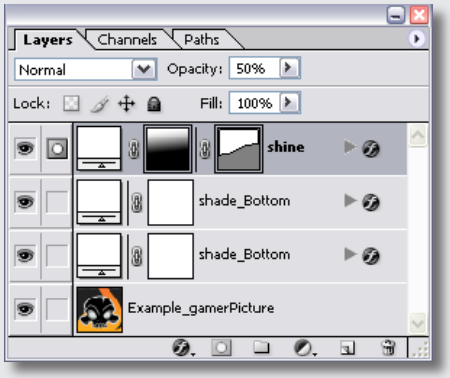
-save image as optimized in ImageReady as an 8-bit png

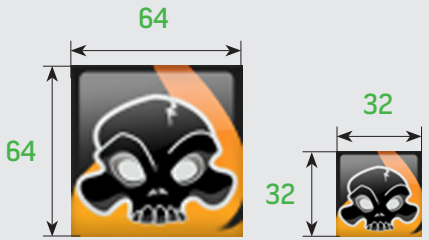
Cropped Image



Bad Gamer Pictures

Apply Shine Treatment





Banners

Banners are promotional areas and can be used throughout the sections. They have set sizes depending on which section they will appear.
(illustrated in following pages)

Banner images will be placed into a inset button border. The edges of the image within border should be faded into the background color for a softer effect. When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.
(see feathering instructions)

All banners with in a button have a focus state that activates when it is rolled over. If a banner is non-selectable it appears grayed-out, but it still has a focus state as you can still roll over it.

Normal state

Focus state

Non-active state

Non-active focus state

Banners

Feathering Instructions (actionscript):

Using Automated Action (Using Photoshop)

1. Open Flattened Sized PNG Banner in Photoshop
   a. Sizes (in pixels)
      i. 345x94 Dash Top level live blade
      ii. 420x72 Marketplace Small
      iii. 420x358 Marketplace Large
      iv. 345x240 BillBoard
      v. 420x95 Guide Home & Marketplace
      vi. 728 x 90 Marketplace New Arrivals

2. Go to “Window” and Select “Actions” (Alt-F9)

3. Open Actions palette Properties drop down (located on the top right of actions palette)

4. Select “Load Actions”

5. Select and load the Supplied actions file “Xbox360 Banner Actions.atn”

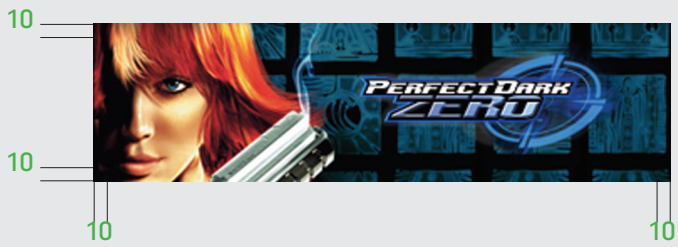
6. In Actions Palette select the “Xbox360 Banner Feathering” layer

7. In Actions Palette select the Play Button (located on the lower right of actions palette)
-Actions will play and create feathered banner

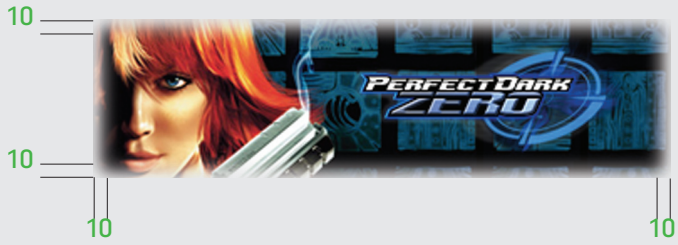
8. Hide the “Background” Layer if still visible.

9. Save as...

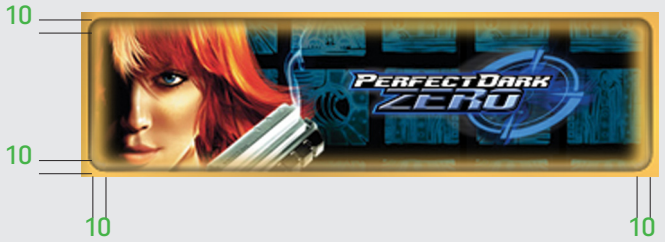
*Manual feathering instructions on next page.



Raw Image
(before script)



Feathered Banner
(after script)



Final Banner
(With button border)

Feathering Instructions (manual):

Manual Steps (Using Photoshop)

1. Open Flattened Sized PNG Banner in Photoshop
   a. Sizes (in pixels)
      i. 345x94 Top level Live\Games Blade
      ii. 420x72 Marketplace Small
      iii. 420x358 Marketplace Large
      iv. 345x240 BillBoard
      v. 420x95 Guide Home & Marketplace
      vi. 728 x 90 Marketplace New Arrivals

2. Duplicate Background Layer

3. Select the “Rectangle Marquee Tool” from the tools palette

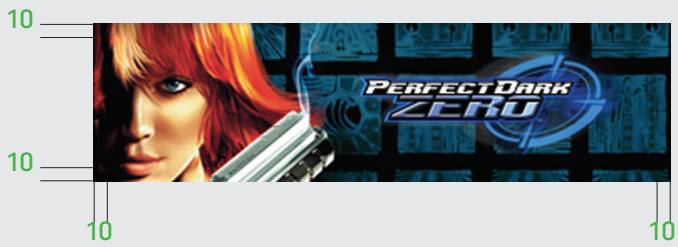
4. Change the “Feather” input box to 6px

5. Drag a marquee selection from the top left corner of the document to the bottom right corner (should result in a rounded corner selection)

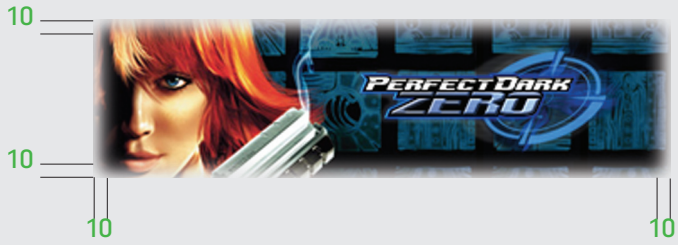
6. Go to “Select” drop down and select “Inverse”

7. Press “Delete” on keyboard three (3) Times

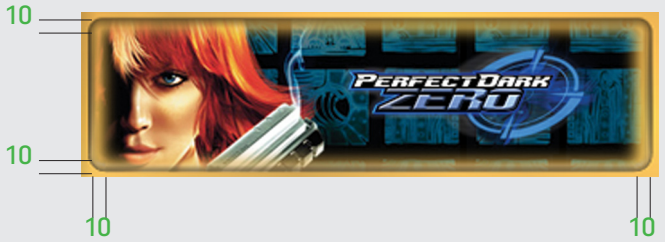
8. Save as...



Raw Image
(before steps)



Feathered Banner
(after steps)



Final Banner
(With button border)

Banners

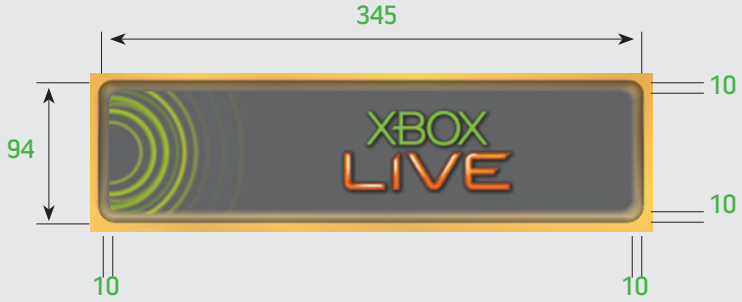
Top level banner

Size:
345 X 94 (in pixels)

Location:
Xbox Live blade top level
Games Blade Top Level

Notes:
Create artwork at the given dimensions and save them out in Feathered PNG format. When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.

Xbox Live Blade (top level)



Banners

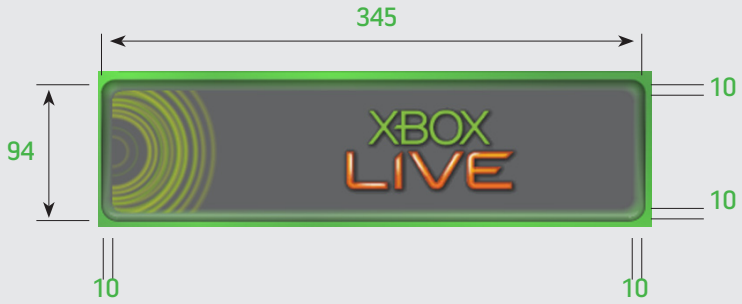
Top level banner

Size:
345 X 94 (in pixels)

Location:
Xbox Live blade top level
Games Blade Top Level

Notes:
Create artwork at the given dimensions and save them out in Feathered PNG format. When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.

Games Blade (top level)



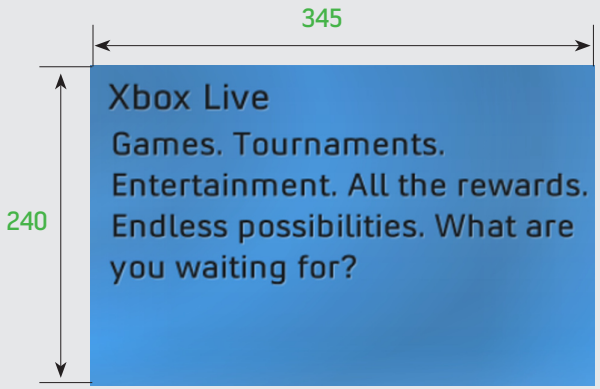
Banners

Billboard Banner of the Day

Size:
345x240 (in pixels)

Location:
Xbox 360 Dashboard top level
(Live Blade, Games Blade, and Media Blade)
The user is unable to navigate to this banner meaning this is banner is not selectable.

Billboard Banner of the Day



Banners

Marketplace Banners

Size:
a. 420 x 72 (in pixels)
b. 420 x 358

Location:
Xbox Live Marketplace Top and 2nd Level

Notes:
Create artwork at the given dimensions and save them out in PNG format.

Annimated Banners

Banners have the possibilty of being animated. When creating an animated banners keep these guidelines in mind:

- Animation should be subtle and elegant. It should not distract or annoy the user.

- Animation must stay within the banner borders.

- Avoid using bright white backgrounds in banners, the focus state is a white highlight\ glow and white backgrounds will decrease discoverability.

- Limit the number of PNG's and Jpegs to reduce filesize and enhance performance.

- Focus animations should be no longer than 1-2 seconds.

Banners

Marketplace Small

Size:
420 X 72 (in pixels)

Location:
Marketplace (2nd level)

Notes:
When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.

Annimated Banners

Banners have the possibilty of being animated. When creating an animated banners keep these guidelines in mind:

- Animation should be subtle and elegant. It should not distract or annoy the user.

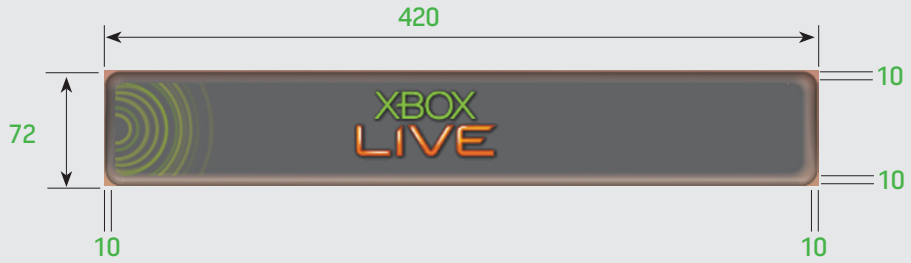
- Animation must stay within the banner borders.

- Avoid using bright white backgrounds in banners, the focus state is a white highlight\ glow and white backgrounds will decrease discoverability.

- Limit the number of PNG's and Jpegs to reduce filesize and enhance performance.

- Focus animations should be no longer than 1-2 seconds.

Xbox Live Marketplace (2nd level)



Banners

Marketplace New Arrivals or Spotlight

Size:
728 x 90 (in pixels)

Location:
Marketplace (2nd level)

Notes:
When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.

Annimated Banners

Banners have the possibilty of being animated. When creating an animated banners keep these guidelines in mind:

- Animation should be subtle and elegant. It should not distract or annoy the user.

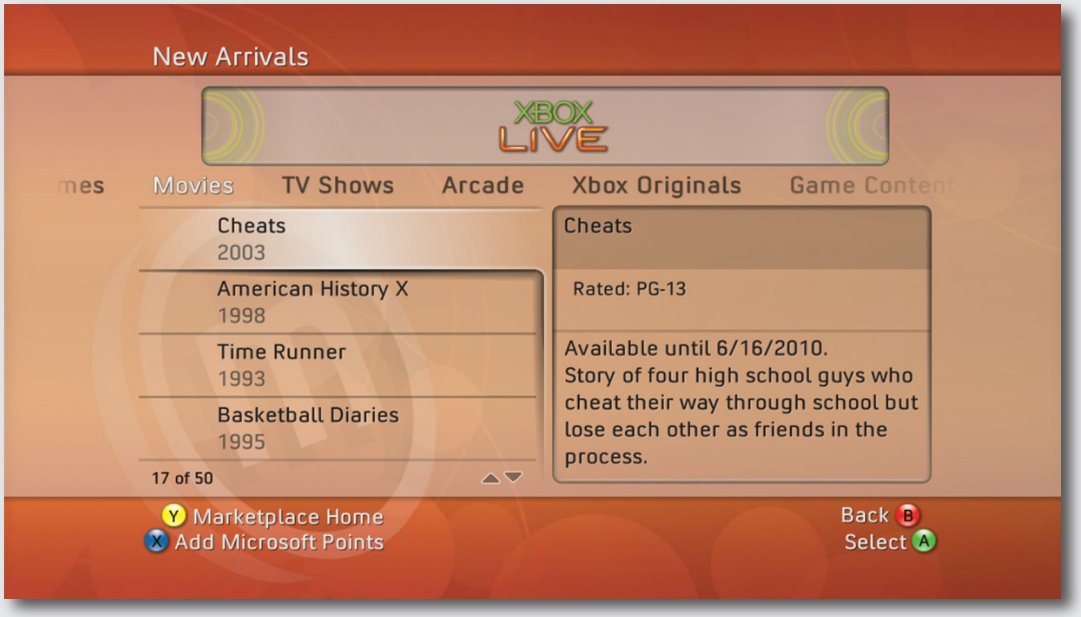
- Animation must stay within the banner borders.

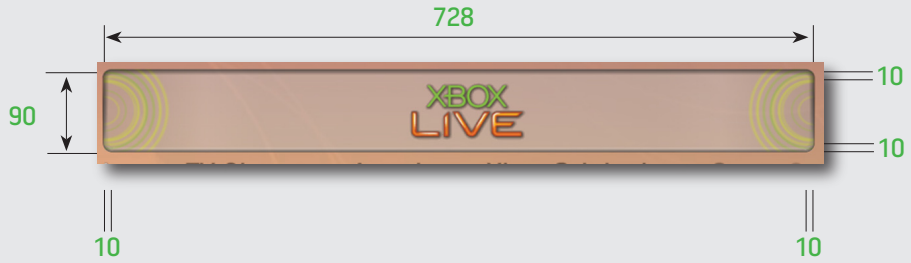
- Avoid using bright white backgrounds in banners, the focus state is a white highlight\ glow and white backgrounds will decrease discoverability.

- Limit the number of PNG's and Jpegs to reduce filesize and enhance performance.

- Focus animations should be no longer than 1-2 seconds.

Xbox Live Marketplace New Arrivals or Spotlight (2nd level)





Banners

Marketplace Large

Size:
420 X 358 (in pixels)

Location:
Marketplace (2nd level)

Notes:
When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.

Annimated Banners

Banners have the possibilty of being animated. When creating an animated banners keep these guidelines in mind:

- Animation should be subtle and elegant. It should not distract or annoy the user.

- Animation must stay within the banner borders.

- Avoid using bright white backgrounds in banners, the focus state is a white highlight\ glow and white backgrounds will decrease discoverability.

- Limit the number of PNG's and Jpegs to reduce filesize and enhance performance.

- Focus animations should be no longer than 1-2 seconds.

Xbox Live Marketplace (2nd level)

Banners

Guide Home Banner

Size:

420 x 95 (in pixels)

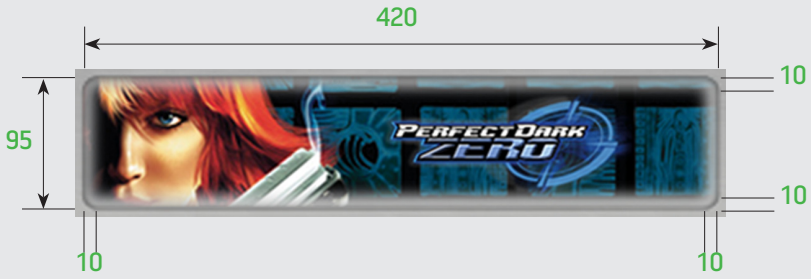
Location:

Guide Home

Notes:

When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.

Guide Home



Banners

Guide Marketplace Banner

Size:

420 x 95 (in pixels)

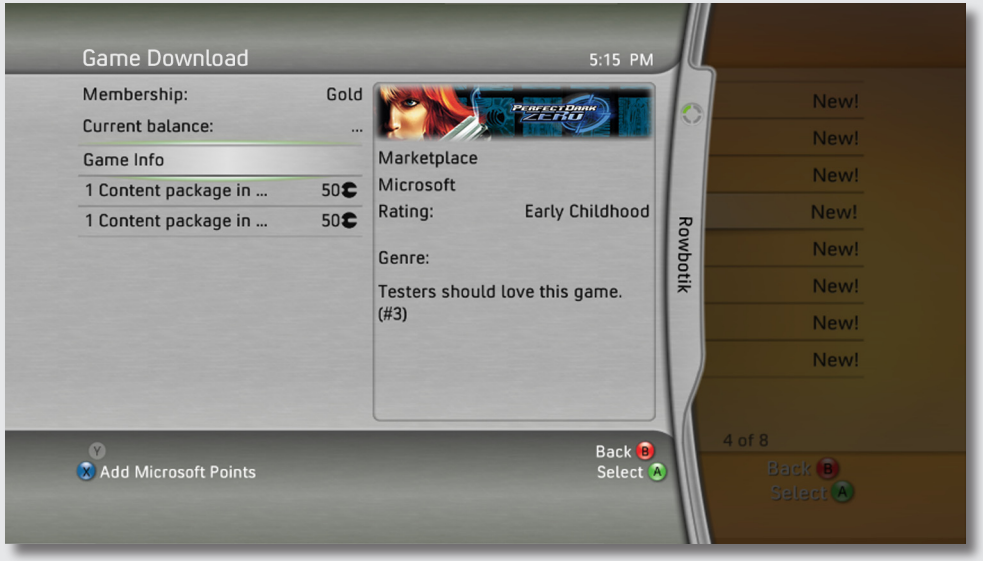
Location:

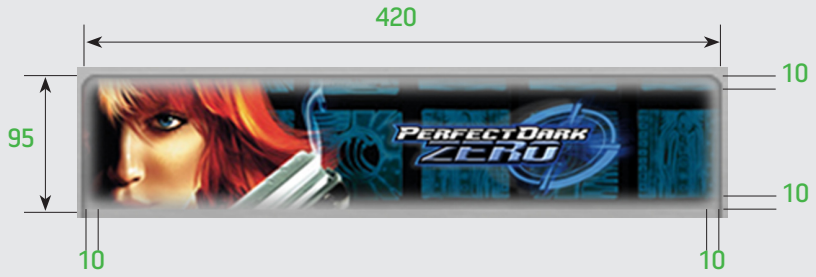
Guide Marketplace metapanel header

Notes:

When creating the artwork do not include any text or content sensitive art 10 pixels from the outer boarder of the banners.

Guide Marketplace





Fonts

Convection and Convection UI are the only fonts used throughout the interface.

The minimum font size is 24pt in Photoshop - or equivalent in Xui.

All text should be legible from a comfortable viewing distance - approximately 10ft.

Ensure there is a high contrast between the text Color and background Color to ensure legibility.

In the Dash a drop shadow is added to help text clarity. To add a drop in XUI, check the "Dropshadow" box in textStyle.

Dash:

Text Color	**R:**15	**G:**15	**B:**15	**A:**230
Drop Shadow	**R:**235	**G:**235	**B:**235	**A:**90

Guide:

Text Color	**R:**15	**G:**15	**B:**15	**A:**230

Convection

a b c d e f g h i j k l m n
o p q r s t u v w x y z
A B C D E F G H I J K L M N
O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Convection UI

a b c d e f g h i j k l m n
o p q r s t u v w x y z
A B C D E F G H I J K L M N
O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Icons

Xbox 360's icon style is simple, sophisticated, and easy to read on a TV screen. Each icon is rendered in a vector program and then manipulated in Adobe Photoshop to produce a transparent PNG format.

These guidelines are geared towards designers. It is recommend you work with a good graphic designer, especially one with experience in using vector programs to create images.

Icon Style Characteristics

- Angle provide a dynamic energy to the images.
- Edges and corners of elements are slightly rounded.
- Light source is coming from the top creating a subtle glass reflection effect.
- A drop shadow provides contrast and dimension.

Icon Sizes

There are three sizes of Xbox 360 icons:

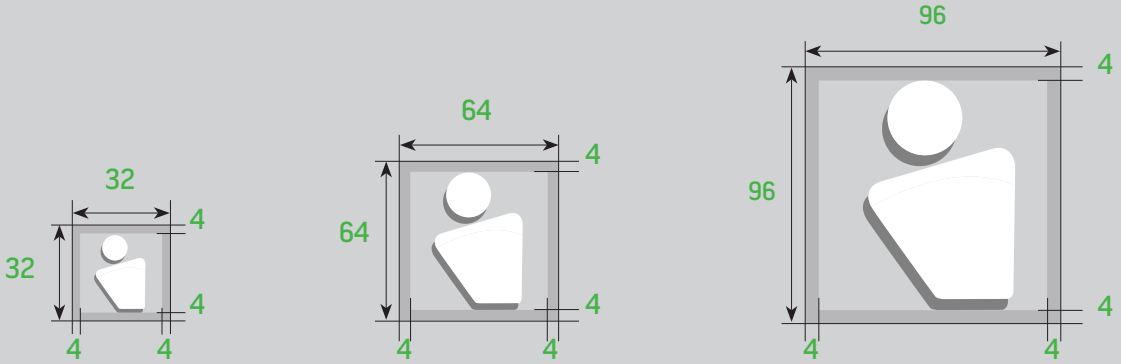
- 96 × 96 pixels
- 64 × 64 pixels
- 32 × 32 pixels

* There is a 4 pixel buffer area included in total size (see "icon sizes" to the right).

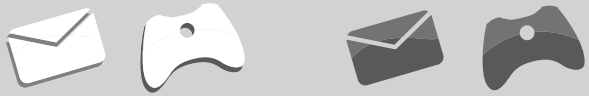
There are two colors of Xbox 360 icons:

- Black
- white (with dark gray drop shadow)

Icon Sizes



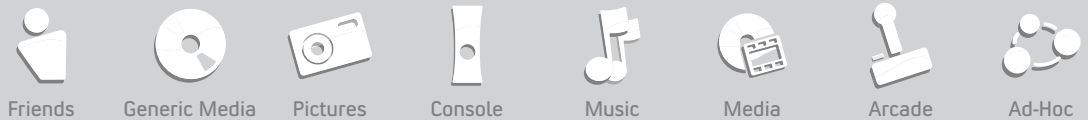
Icon Colors



White

Black

Icon Examples



Friends | Generic Media | Pictures | Console | Music | Media | Arcade | Ad-Hoc

Chat | MU | Unlock | USB | Recent Player | Sound | Wired Controller | Hard Drive

Icon Creation

STEP BY STEP ICON CREATION

MAIN SHAPE

1. Draw the main shape icon in Illustrator or Freehand
2. Rotate icon 15 Degrees
3. Change Opacity to 50%

SHADOW (only on white icons)

4. Copy main image to create shadow.
5. Change color to black
6. Change black opacity to 50%
7. Lower the copy shape a couple of pixels
8. Select both shapes
9. In Pathfinders, click divide to break the shadow shape apart.
10. Delete the shape behind the main shape, leaving only the shadow part.

GLASS REFLECTION EFFECT

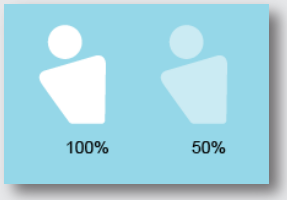
11. Create glass reflection effect on top of the main shape using white color.
12. Change reflection opacity to 35% on WHITE icon, 15% on BLACK icon.

TRANSFER TO PHOTOSHOP

13. Group individual icons
14. Select and copy
15. Paste into PSD file with transparent background
14. Save file to transparent PNG

Icon Creation Steps (referenced on left)

Step 3: 50% Opacity



Step 9: Drop Shadow pathfinder (divide)

Step 10: Drop Shadow

Title Safe

Screen

1120 x 770

Title safe

955 x 590

Animation

Style

Animation and movement are an integral part of the interface design. It's what brings the screens to life, injects character and makes them interesting to interact with, time after time. Animation draws the user's eye to a particular area and allows us to create a focus for each screen.

Every element of every page needs to be considered in order to make the interface feel like a living, breathing organism that moves as a whole.

Whether it's the movement of the blades sweeping from side to side, or how content appears on the screen, it all needs to have the same characteristics:

- organic
- fluid
- light
- living
- energy

Blades

The blades should appear to sweep fluidly across the screen - back and forth. When they're selected they should seem to peel back to reveal content. They should feel light, almost weightless - not heavy.

The jewels on each blade should be grey and transparent when deselected. But when selected they should flood with Color and pulse with energy. They should remain in Color and gently pulsing while selected.

Backgrounds

The backgrounds that feature on every screen set the mood of the interface. Imagine a gaseous energy that represents the core and is trapped behind the screen. It moves slowly, almost hypnotic, beautiful. It should also reinforce the feeling of depth and perspective as the gaseous elements appear to move closer to the screen or away from it.

The background should always seem fluid and random rather than on a loop.

Content

How all the content loads onto and moves off the page should be considered and should add to the organic, fluid feel.

Page elements

The individual page elements - the banners, meta panels and links need to feel like you can almost touch them. The main purpose of using animation here is to highlight the focus on the screen. Every element should appear to come out of the screen as it is rolled over and in its focus state (see below).

Rollovers

The rollover, or focus state, should appear to elevate out of the screen - a smooth motion rather than a sudden jump. The focus state should be clearly visible so it doesn't get lost on the screen.

Also, each button has a further animated focus state to enhance its visibility. The flex buttons have an animated sheen and the glass buttons gently pulse.

Annimated Banners

Banners have the possibilty of being animated. When creating an animated banners keep these guidelines in mind:

- Animation should be subtle and elegant. It should not distract or annoy the user.
- Animation must stay within the banner borders.
- Avoid using bright white backgrounds in banners, the focus state is a white highlight\ glow and white backgrounds will decrease discoverability.
- Limit the number of PNG's and Jpegs to reduce filesize and enhance performance.
- Focus animations should be no longer than 1-2 seconds.

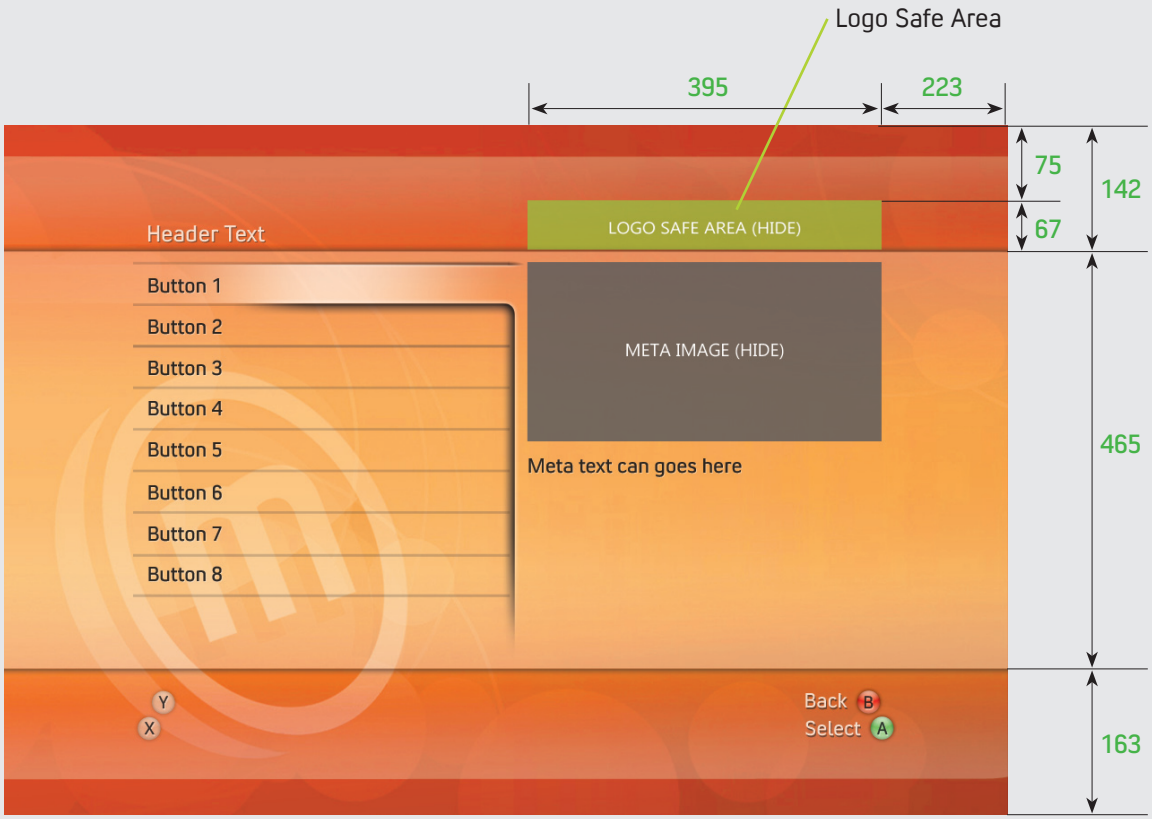
XBOX 360™

BRANDED DESTINATION EXPERIENCE

Custom Advertisement Background Guidelines

Logo Placement

The network logo can be placed anywhere in the background (refer to the test .PSD to make sure your logo doesn't come in contact with the 'Potential Lost Areas').
A 'Logo Safe Area' also appears in the test file. If the network logo is placed inside this area, it will appear above the Dashboard content panel, acting as a screen header.



Ad Details

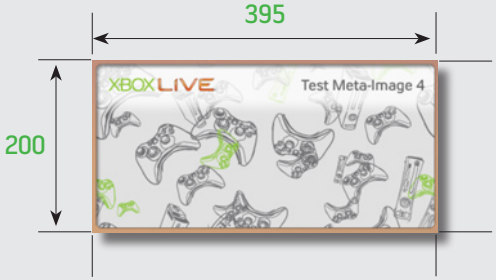
Ad Details
The Ad Details scene can have up to 8 buttons that are associated with meta panels on the right. The meta panels can either contain purely text or a combination of image and text. When an image is present there is space for seven lines of text.

Meta panel image Size:
- 395 x 200 pixels

Location:
Marketplace (3rd leve)

Notes:
When creating the artwork for the meta panels the border and style is fairly open. Follow the same aesthetic guidelines as all other images in the dash. Feathering the edges is not required. Be aware of tv safe colors and keep banner subtle, clean, and elegant.

Ad Details (3rd Level



Ad Details More Info Scene (with image)

Ad Details More Info Scene
The Ad Details More Info scene has an image at the top with bulleted text below. There is space for up to 4 bullets with 2 lines of text for each.

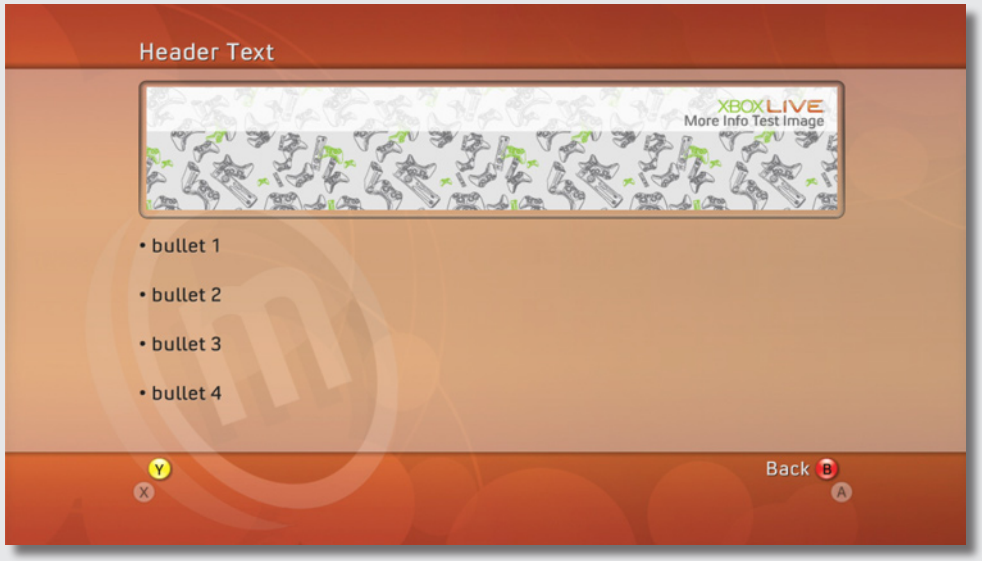
Meta panel image Size:
- 805 x 150 pixels

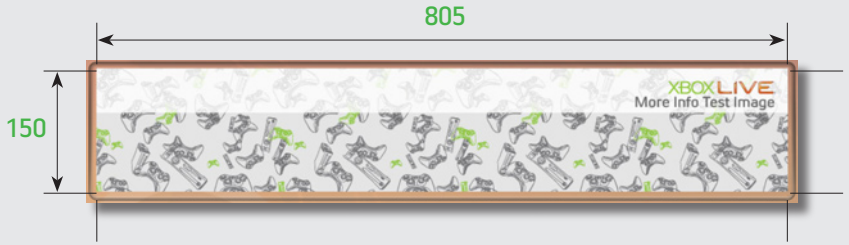
Location:
Marketplace (3rd leve)

Notes:
When creating the artwork follow the same aesthetic guidelines as all other images in the dash. Be aware of tv safe colors and keep banner subtle, clean, and elegant.

Do NOT feather the edges like in other dash banners.

Ad Details (3rd Level



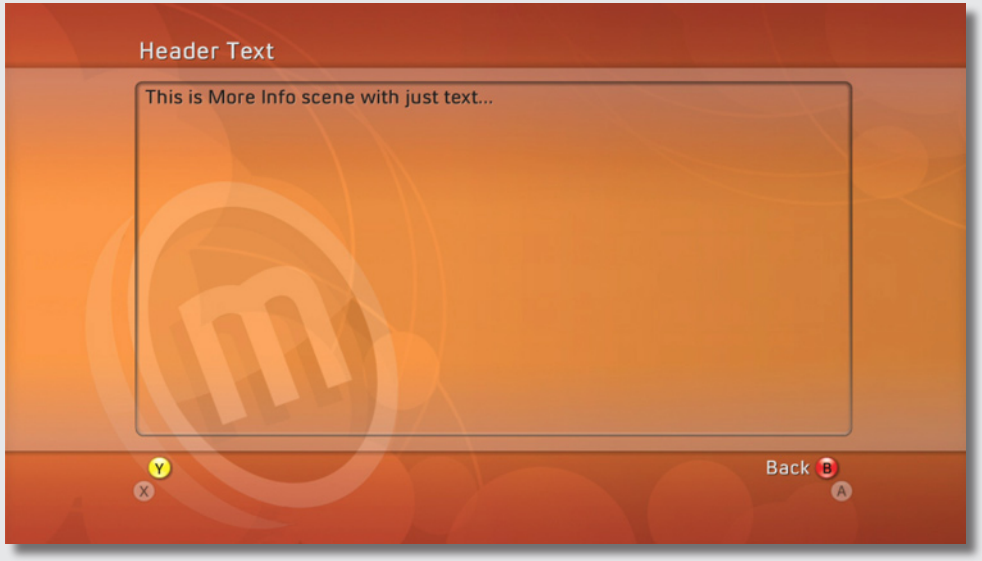


Ad Details More Info Scene (Text only)

Ad Details More Info Scene
The Ad Details More Info scene (text only) has space for up to 13 lines of text.

Location:
Marketplace (3rd leve)

More Info text only (3rd Level)



Ad Details Video Scene

Ad Details Video Scene
The Ad Details Video Scene contains a video and space for one line of description text.

Video Size:

Container:	640 x 360
Native Video File:	320 x 180

Location:

Marketplace (3rd leve)

Notes:

The video is scaled to fit within the border in the XUI tool. The native file dimesions can be up to 640x360 pixels.

More Info text only (3rd Level)

APPENDIX

Appendix